

Jira Software for Beginners - Complete Training Manual

Training Document | 43 Steps | Generated by InstructorAssess AI

Overview

This comprehensive training manual covers everything needed to successfully use Jira Software for agile project management, specifically designed for complete beginners. The manual walks through creating and managing an e-commerce shopping application project using both Scrum and Kanban methodologies within Jira Software.

The training demonstrates the complete project lifecycle from initial setup through sprint completion, including creating epics, user stories, tasks, and bugs; organizing work with labels, components, and versions; grooming and prioritizing the backlog; executing sprints; and generating reports. By the end of this guide, users will have hands-on experience with all core Jira Software features and be able to confidently manage agile projects.

The project example used throughout is an e-commerce shopping software application that allows customers to search for and purchase products from physical retail stores using their mobile devices, providing a realistic context for learning Jira's capabilities.

Prerequisites

- Free Jira Software account (create using provided link)
- Basic understanding of software development concepts
- Web browser with internet access
- Access to the free Jira guide document at alvinthePM.com/freeguide
- No prior Jira experience required (this is a beginner tutorial)

Key Concepts

Agile Methodology Fundamentals

Agile is a methodology that uses an iterative approach to develop products, building and releasing them incrementally instead of trying to deliver everything at the project's end like traditional waterfall approaches. Agile promotes early delivery and focuses on adapting to changing requirements as customer feedback is obtained during every iteration.

Scrum vs Kanban:

- **Scrum****: Uses time-boxed periods called "sprints" (typically 2 weeks) where teams commit to completing specific work and delivering a working product
- **Kanban****: Continuous flow approach without sprints, where work is pulled from left to right on a board as capacity becomes available

Sprint Workflow:

1. **Sprint Planning Meeting**: Team discusses and agrees upon work to complete, estimating effort and creating a sprint backlog
2. **Daily Scrum**: 15-minute daily meetings to review progress and identify roadblocks
3. **Sprint Review**: Team presents developed product to stakeholders for feedback
4. **Sprint Retrospective**: Team reflects on process improvements

PART 1: Data Model & Entities

Jira Account Hierarchy

JIRA Account Instance (Company website)

└─ Project A

└─ Project B

└─ Project C (Different projects for products, software applications, or services)

Core Issue Types

Epic: Largest chunk of work that cannot be completed in one sprint. Used to categorize work and represent high-level product features (e.g., User Account Management, Shopping Interface Module, Product Search Optimization).

Story (User Story): Represents new functionality from user's perspective. Written in format: "As a [USER TYPE], I want [SOME CAPABILITY], so that [A BENEFIT] can be achieved."

Task: Work required to complete an item, typically technical implementation tasks.

Bug: Defects discovered in previously completed user stories that need resolution.

Sub-task: Found underneath stories, should be completed in one day or less to encourage detailed work breakdown.

Project Data Model - E-commerce Shopping App

[Frame:102][Frame:103]

Project: E-commerce Shopping Software Application

- Purpose**: Allow customers to search for and buy products from physical retail stores using their phone
- Key**: ESA (E-commerce Shopping App)
- Template**: Scrum methodology

Seven Core Epics:

1. Shopping Cart (#1)
2. Cancelling Orders (#2)
3. User Account (#3)
4. Shopping Interface (#4)
5. Product Search (#5)
6. Loyalties Program (#6)
7. Shopping Location (#7)

Data Relationships:

- Projects contain Epics
- Epics contain User Stories, Tasks, and Bugs
- User Stories can contain Sub-tasks
- All issues have unique keys (ESA-1, ESA-2, etc.)
- Issues can be assigned to Components, Versions, and Labels
- Issues flow through Status workflows (To Do → In Progress → Done)

PART 2: Screen-by-Screen UI Specification

Main Navigation Structure

Left Sidebar - Planning Section:

- ESA board (Active Sprint view)
- Timeline

- Backlog (Primary work management)
- Active sprints
- Reports

Left Sidebar - Development Section:

- Components NEW
- Code
- Releases

Backlog Interface

Layout Components:

- Left Panel**: Epic filters, Version filters, Label filters, Component filters
- Main Content**: Issue list with drag-and-drop capability
- Right Panel**: Issue detail view (opens when issue selected)

Issue List Columns:

- Checkbox (for bulk selection)
- Issue type icon (Epic, Story, Task, Bug, Sub-task)
- Issue key (ESA-XX)
- Summary text
- Epic label
- Status (To Do, In Progress, Done)
- Story points (gray circle)
- Priority (dots indicating level)
- Assignee avatar
- Version tag
- Component labels

Epic Panel Controls:

- Keyboard shortcut: E (toggles Epic panel)
- Expandable/collapsible epic sections
- Issue counts per epic
- Color-coding capability for visual grouping

Sprint Board Interface

Column Structure:

- TO DO (leftmost column)
- IN PROGRESS
- TO VERIFY (custom column)

- DONE (rightmost column)

Board Features:

- Drag-and-drop between columns
- Issue cards with key, title, assignee
- Column issue counts
- Sprint timer (days remaining)
- Complete Sprint button

Issue Creation Dialog

[Frame:108][Frame:109]

Required Fields:

- Project (auto-populated)
- Issue type (dropdown: Task, Story, Bug, Epic)
- Summary (required text field)

Optional Fields:

- Status (defaults to "To Do")
- Epic Name (for Epic type only)
- Parent (for linking to Epic)
- Components (multi-select)
- Description (rich text editor with formatting)
- Reporter (auto-populated with creator)
- Priority (dropdown: Highest, High, Medium, Low, Lowest)
- Labels (tags for categorization)
- Linked Issues (dependencies)
- Assignee (person selector)
- Sprint assignment
- Fix versions

Issue Detail Panel

Sections:

- Pinned Fields**: Most important/frequently used fields
- Details**: Standard issue metadata (Assignee, Reporter, Labels, Epic Link, Priority, Components)
- More Fields**: Additional optional fields
- Activity**: Comments, history, work log

Action Buttons:

- Attach file
- Add child issue
- Link issue
- Edit (pencil icon)
- More actions (three dots)

Reports Interface

Available Reports:

- Burndown Chart (sprint progress visualization)
- Sprint Report (completed vs incomplete work)
- Velocity Chart (team performance over time)
- Cumulative Flow Diagram
- Control Chart
- Epic Burndown

PART 3: Workflow & Business Logic

Issue Status Workflow

Standard Flow: To Do → In Progress → Done

Extended Flow (with verification): To Do → In Progress → To Verify → Done

Status Transitions:

- Issues start in "To Do" status when created
- Move to "In Progress" when work begins
- Move to "To Verify" for review/testing (if column exists)
- Move to "Done" when completed

Sprint Management Rules

Sprint Creation:

- Sprints have name, duration (typically 2 weeks), start date, end date
- Sprint goal can be defined
- Issues are moved into sprint from backlog

Sprint Execution:

- Issues can be moved between status columns
- New issues can be added during sprint
- Story points are estimated and tracked

Sprint Completion:

- Completed issues remain in sprint history
- Open issues can be moved to new sprint or back to backlog
- Sprint reports are generated automatically

Backlog Prioritization Logic

Priority Levels: Highest → High → Medium → Low → Lowest

Estimation System: Story points using Fibonacci sequence (1, 2, 3, 5, 8, 13)

- 1 point: Minimum effort, few minutes, little complexity, no risk
- 2-3 points: Small tasks, hours to complete
- 5-8 points: Medium complexity, days to complete
- 13+ points: Should be broken down into smaller stories

Filtering and Organization

[Frame:198][Frame:199]

Filter Types:

- Epic Filter**: Shows issues belonging to specific epics
- Version Filter**: Shows issues assigned to specific releases
- Label Filter**: Shows issues with specific labels
- Component Filter**: Shows issues for specific components

Bulk Operations:

- Select multiple issues via checkboxes
- Bulk edit fields (assignee, labels, epic, version, etc.)
- Bulk move to sprint
- Bulk status changes

Component Assignment Logic

Component Structure:

- Components represent sub-sections of the project
- Example: iOS, Android, Windows for platform compatibility
- Issues can be assigned to one or more components
- Components have leads and default assignees

Version/Release Management

Version Lifecycle:

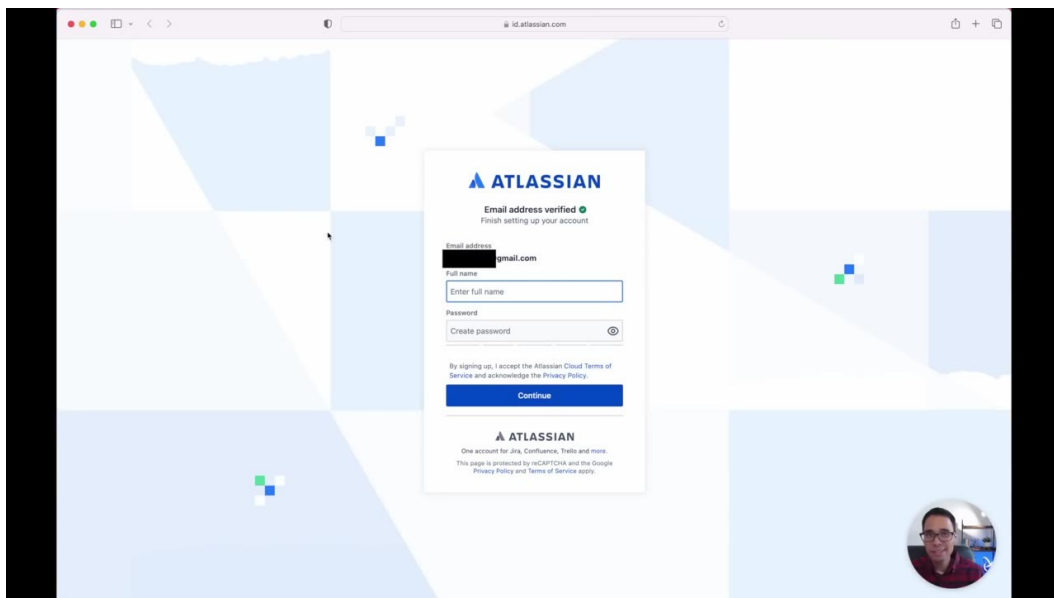
- Versions start as "Unreleased"

- Issues are assigned to target versions
- Versions can be released, which changes status
- Unresolved issues can be moved to next version or left unassigned

PART 4: Step-by-Step User Guide

Section 1: Account Setup and Project Creation

Step 1.1: Create Jira Account



Screenshot at 11:25

Navigation: Direct browser to Atlassian signup page

Action:

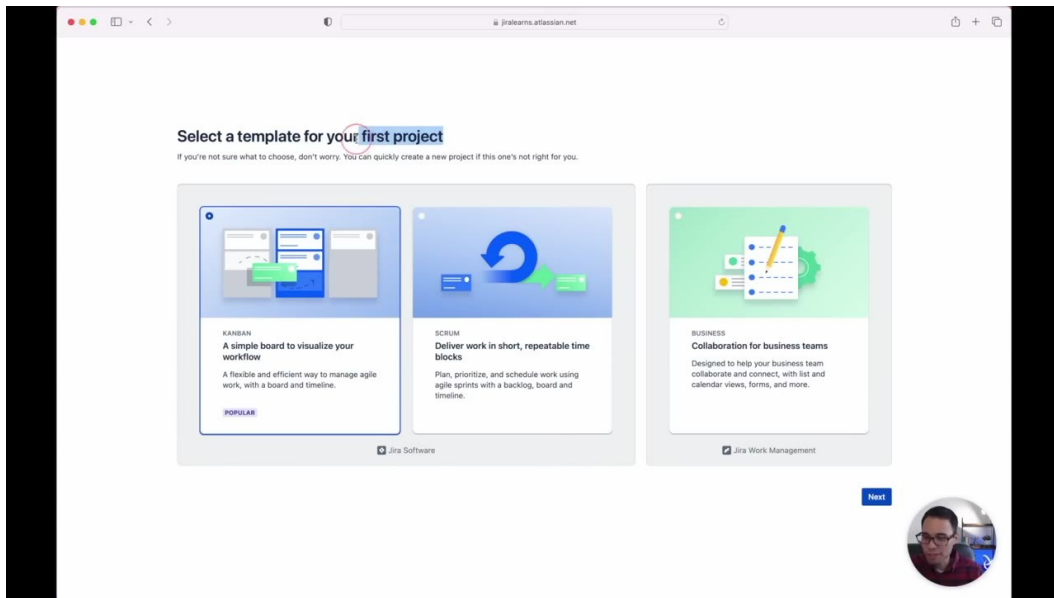
Visit the signup link provided and create your free Jira Software account. Complete the email verification process and set up your full name and password.

Details:

- Use a personal email for learning purposes (separate from company account)
- Choose a unique site name (yourname.atlassian.net)
- This gives you admin privileges for learning

Expected Result: You should have access to Jira Software with your own admin account

Step 1.2: Select Project Template



Screenshot at 11:30

Navigation: Projects → Create Project

Action:

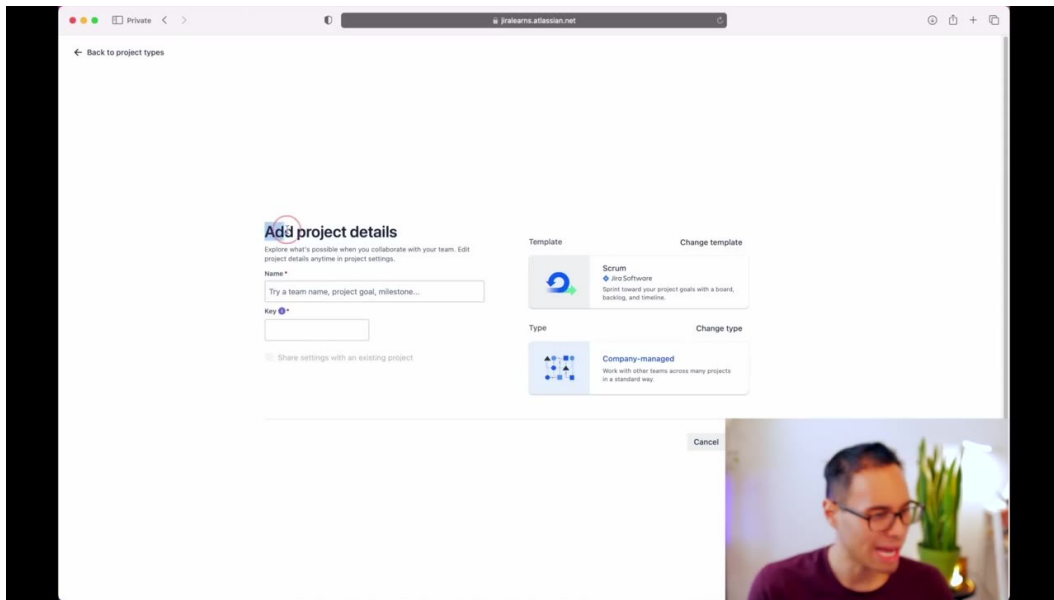
Choose the Scrum template from the Software development category. Select "Company-managed project" for full feature access.

Details:

- Scrum template includes backlog and sprint planning
- Company-managed provides more configuration options
- Team-managed has simplified but limited features

Expected Result: Template selection screen with Scrum highlighted

Step 1.3: Configure Project Details



Screenshot at 16:35

Navigation: Project creation wizard → Add project details

Action:

Enter project name "E-commerce Shopping App" and key "ESA". Click Next to create the project.

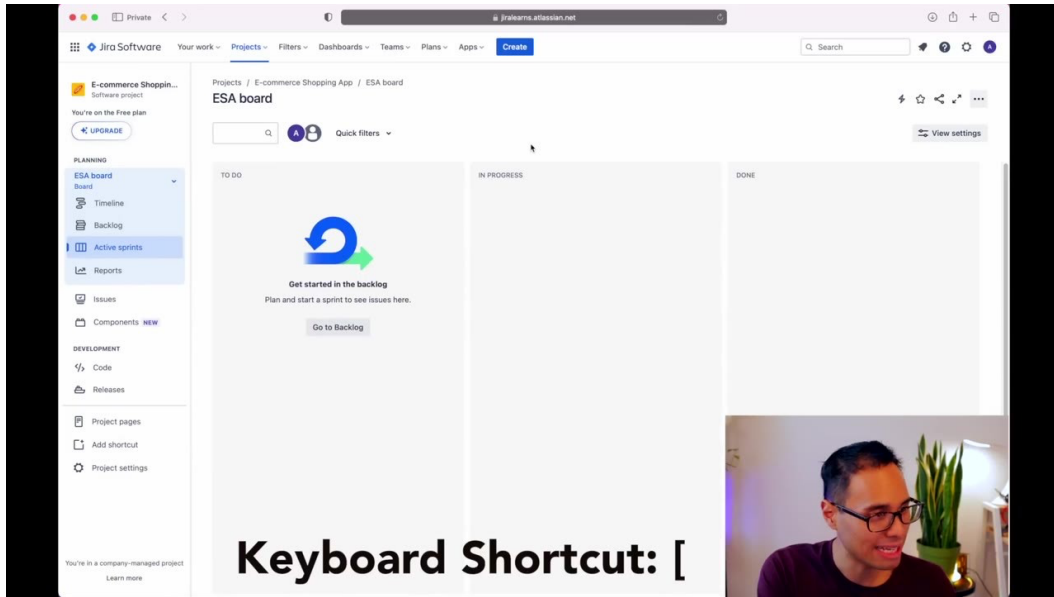
Details:

- Name: E-commerce Shopping App
- Key: ESA (will appear in all issue keys like ESA-1, ESA-2)
- Key should be short and memorable

Expected Result: New project created with empty sprint board displayed

Section 2: Master the Jira Interface

Step 2.1: Navigate to Backlog



Screenshot at 19:25

Navigation: Left sidebar → Backlog

Action:

Click on "Backlog" in the left navigation panel to access the main work management interface.

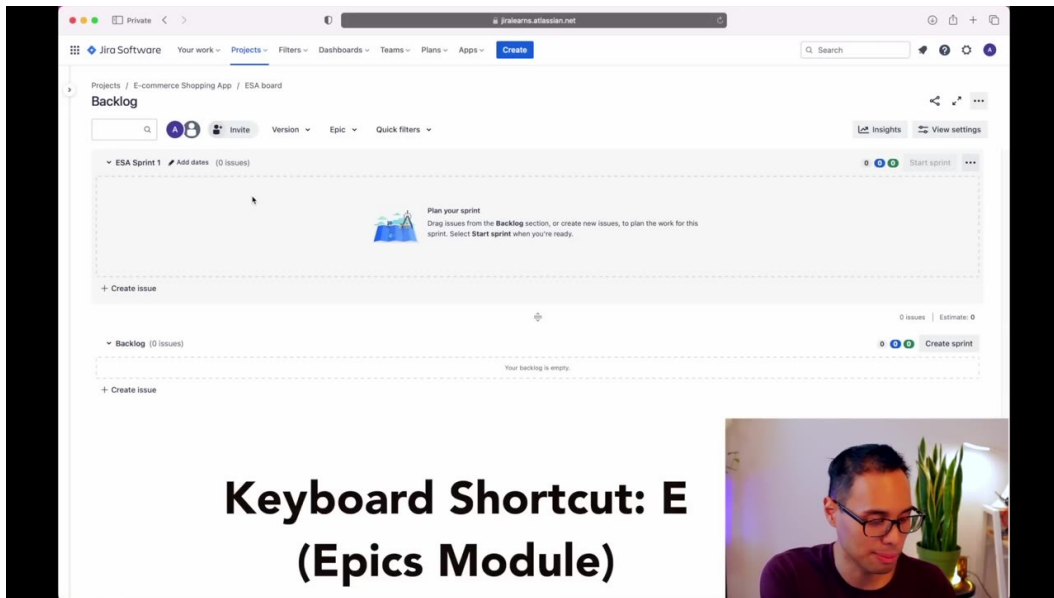
Details:

- Backlog is where all issues are created and managed
- Active Sprints shows current sprint board
- Use keyboard shortcut "1" for Backlog, "2" for Active Sprints

Expected Result: Backlog view with empty issue list and "Plan your sprint" section

TIP: ** Use the "[" keyboard shortcut to collapse/expand the left sidebar for more viewing space

Step 2.2: Learn Epic Panel Controls



Screenshot at 26:40

Navigation: Epic dropdown → Epic

Action:

Open the Epic panel by clicking the Epic dropdown at the top and selecting "Epic".

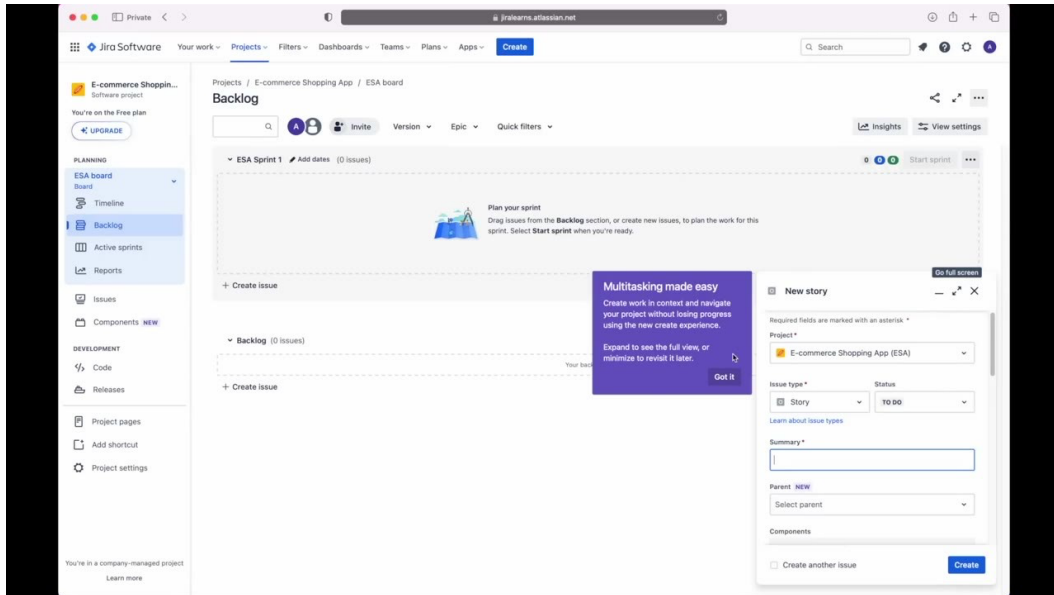
Details:

- Epic panel shows on left side of screen
- Groups issues by epic categories
- Use keyboard shortcut "E" to toggle Epic panel

Expected Result: Epic panel appears on left side, main content shifts right

Section 3: Creating Epics

Step 3.1: Create First Epic (Shopping Cart)



Screenshot at 22:30

[Frame:108][Frame:109]

Navigation: Create button (top toolbar) or keyboard shortcut "C"

Action:

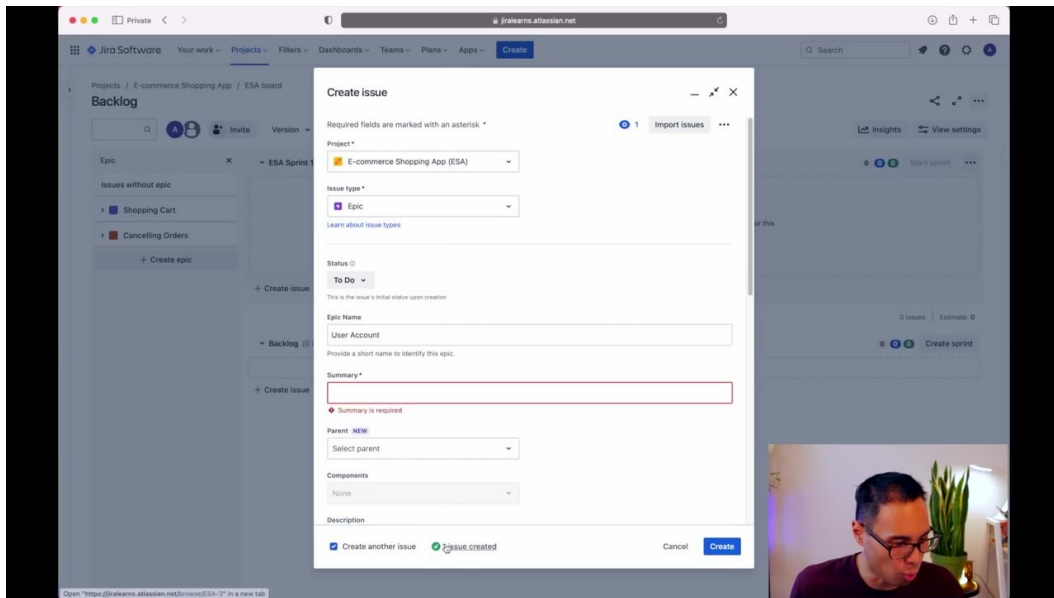
Open the Create issue dialog and select Epic as the issue type. Fill in the epic details.

Details:

- Issue type: Epic
- Epic name: Shopping Cart
- Summary: Shopping Cart
- Description: Purpose: Defining functionality for the shopping cart interface for checking out & purchasing items
- Priority: Medium
- Leave other fields as default

Expected Result: Success notification "ESA-1 issue created" appears

Step 3.2: Create Additional Epics



Screenshot at 27:50

Navigation: Create issue dialog (keep "Create another issue" checked)

Action:

Create the remaining six epics for the project, updating the Epic name and Summary for each.

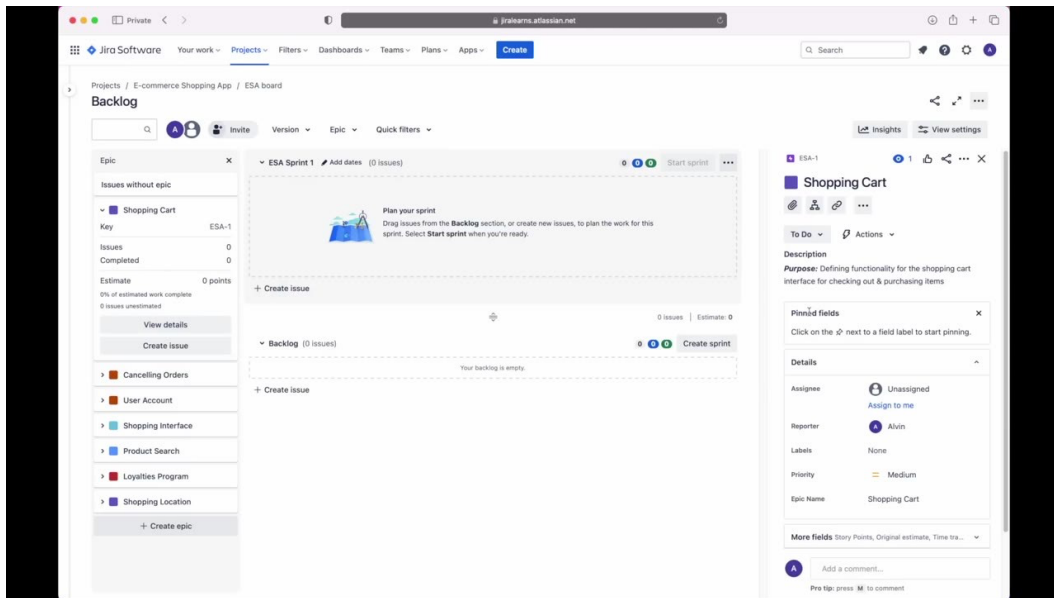
Details:

Create these epics in order:

- Cancelling Orders (ESA-2)
- User Account (ESA-3)
- Shopping Interface (ESA-4)
- Product Search (ESA-5)
- Loyalties Program (ESA-6)
- Shopping Location (ESA-7)

Expected Result: Seven epics created with success notifications showing "5 issues created" after completing all

Step 3.3: View Epic Panel



Screenshot at 29:50

Navigation: Epic dropdown → Epic (if not already open)

Action:

Open the Epic panel to view all created epics organized on the left sidebar.

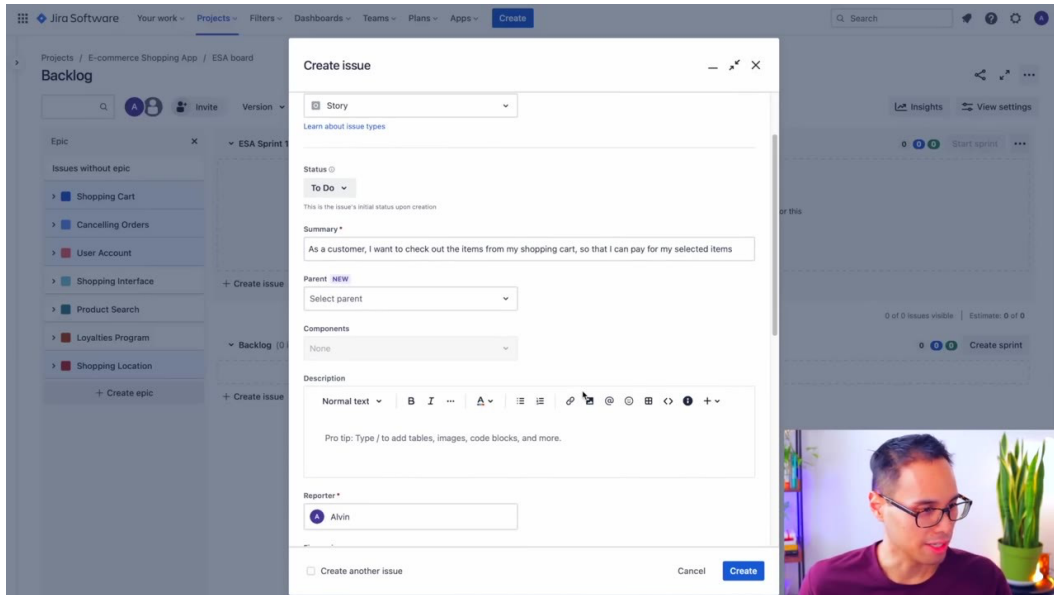
Details:

- Each epic shows issue count (0 issues initially)
- Color coding can be applied for visual organization
- Click epic to expand and see associated issues

Expected Result: Left sidebar shows all seven epics with expand/collapse arrows

Section 4: Creating User Stories and Issues

Step 4.1: Create First User Story



Screenshot at 33:55

Navigation: Create button or keyboard shortcut "C"

Action:

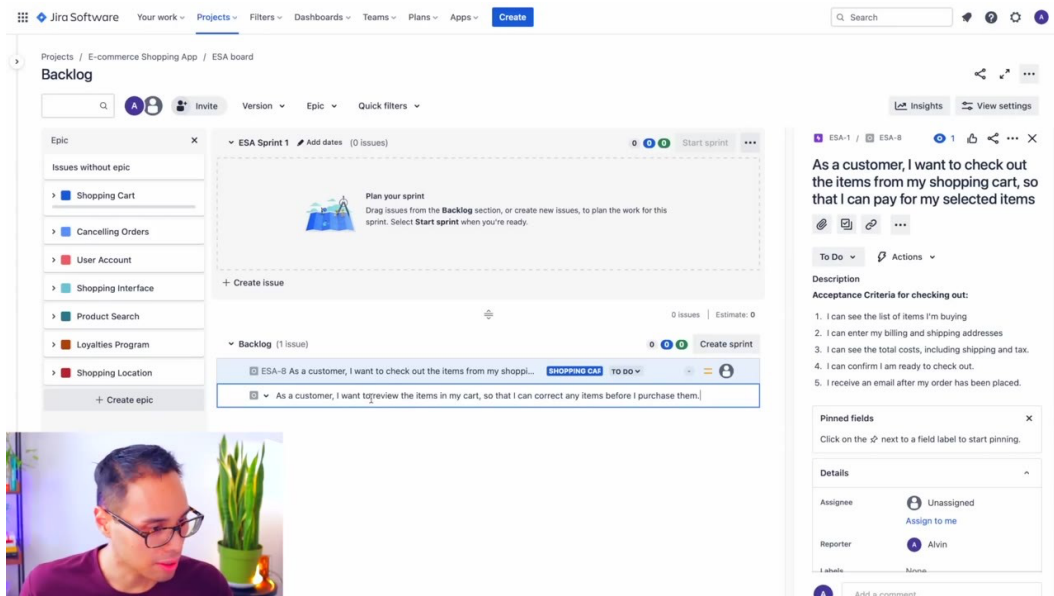
Create the first user story for the Shopping Cart epic with detailed information.

Details:

- Issue type: Story
- Summary: As a customer, I want to check out the items from my shopping cart, so that I can pay for my selected items
- Parent: ESA-1 Shopping Cart
- Description: Include acceptance criteria defining what constitutes completion
- Priority: Medium
- Reporter: (auto-populated)

Expected Result: New user story ESA-8 created and appears in backlog list

Step 4.2: Use Quick Create Method



Screenshot at 37:25

Navigation: Backlog section → + Create issue button

Action:

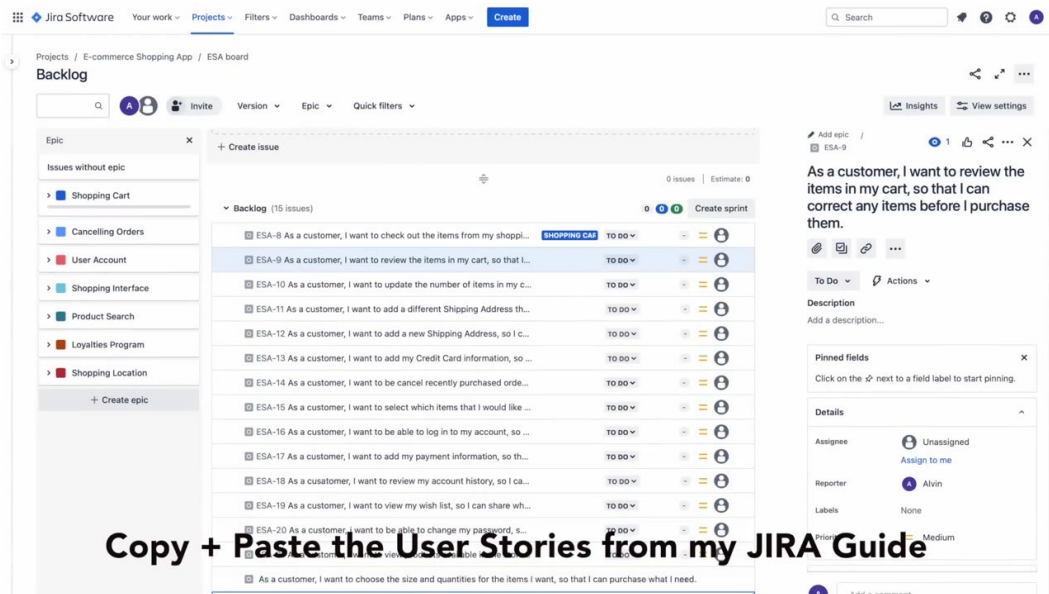
Use the inline create method for faster issue creation by clicking the + Create issue button at the bottom of the backlog.

Details:

- Type issue summary directly in the field
- Press Enter to create
- Fields like epic assignment must be updated later
- Faster for bulk issue creation

Expected Result: New issue added to backlog instantly without opening full dialog

Step 4.3: Bulk Create User Stories



Screenshot at 38:05

[Frame:134][Frame:135]

Navigation: Continue using + Create issue for remaining stories

Action:

Create all user stories for the project using the provided data from the free guide document.

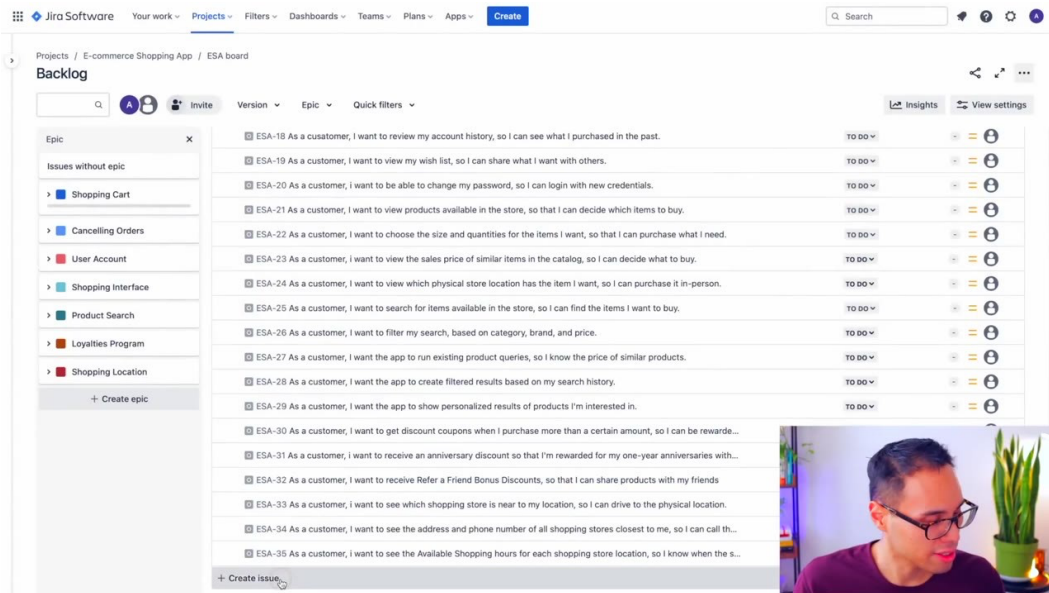
Details:

- Copy and paste user stories from the guide
- Create approximately 30+ user stories covering all epics
- Include bugs and tasks as specified in the guide
- Stories follow format: "As a [user type], I want [capability], so that [benefit]"

Expected Result: Backlog displays 30+ issues without epic assignments

Section 5: Creating Bugs and Subtasks

Step 5.1: Add Bug Issues



Screenshot at 38:20

[Frame:137][Frame:138]

Navigation: + Create issue → Change issue type to Bug

Action:

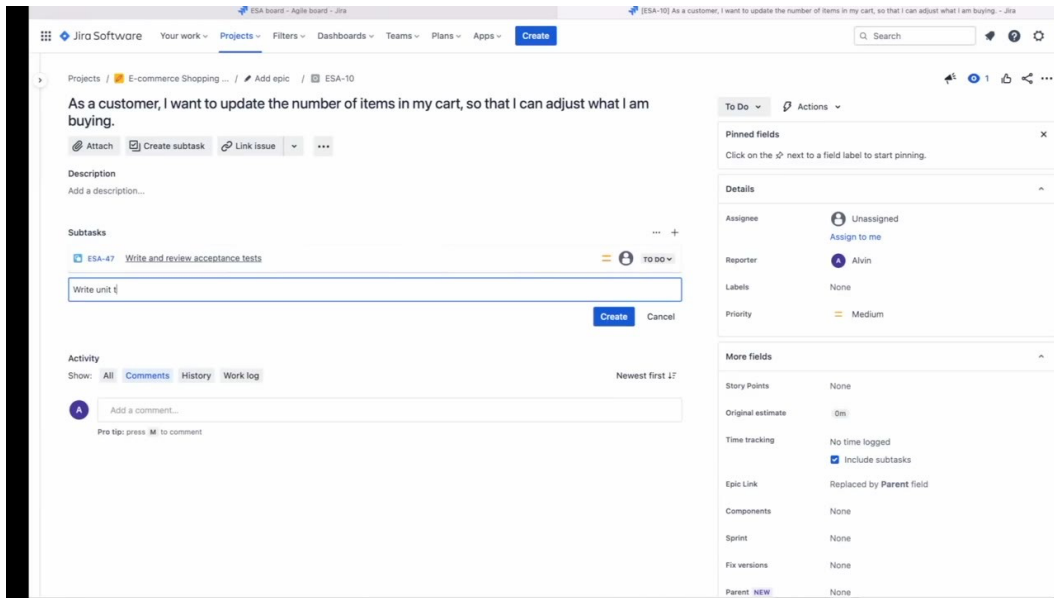
Create bug issues by selecting the Bug issue type (red icon) from the dropdown menu.

Details:

- Issue type: Bug (red icon with white circle)
- Use descriptive bug titles like "Error message when user tries to check out"
- Bugs represent defects in previously completed work
- Will be added to sprints for resolution

Expected Result: Bug issues appear in backlog with red bug icons

Step 5.2: Create Subtasks



Screenshot at 40:30

[Frame:144][Frame:145]

Navigation: Issue detail view → Create subtask button

Action:

Add subtasks to user stories by opening the issue detail and clicking "Create subtask".

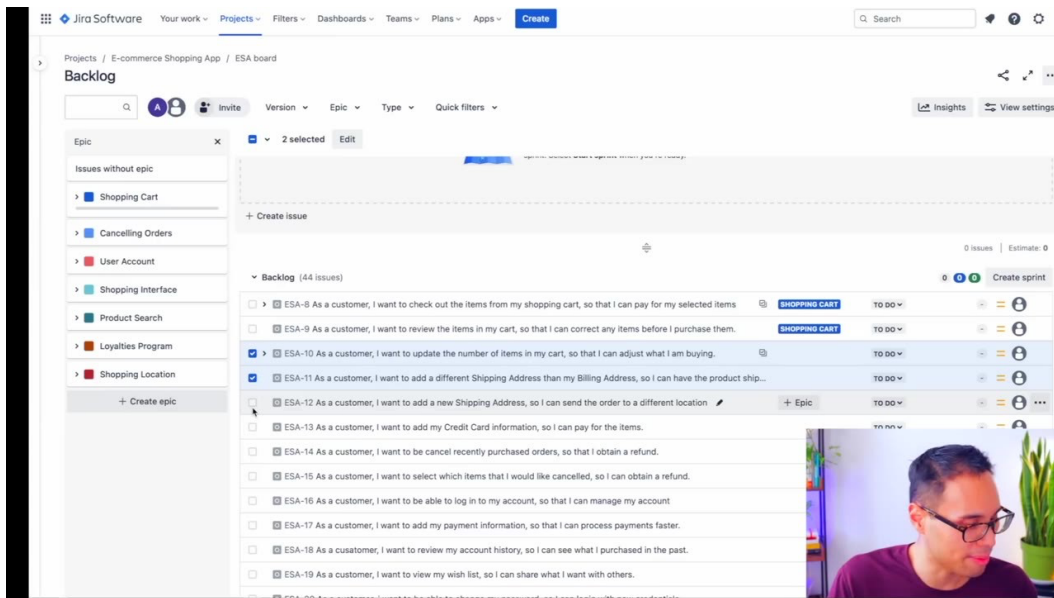
Details:

- Subtasks should be completable in one day or less
- Examples: "Write unit tests", "Create UI mockup", "Run acceptance tests"
- Help break down complex stories into manageable pieces
- Appear indented under parent story

Expected Result: Subtasks appear linked to parent user story in issue detail view

Section 6: Assigning Issues to Epics

Step 6.1: Select Multiple Issues



Screenshot at 41:55

[Frame:149][Frame:150][Frame:151]

Navigation: Backlog → Select issue checkboxes

Action:

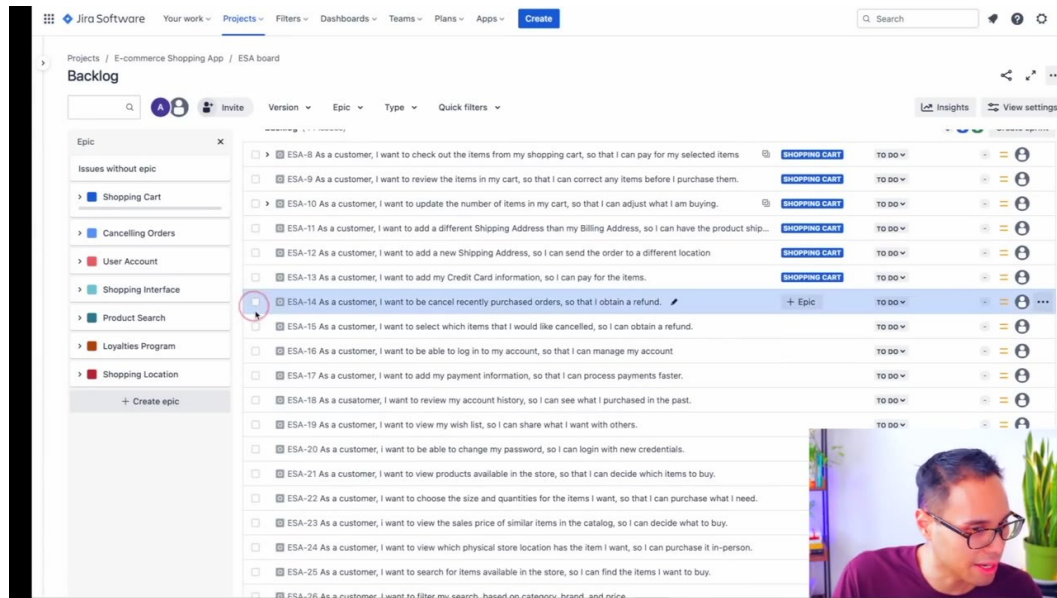
Select multiple user stories by clicking their checkboxes to prepare for bulk epic assignment.

Details:

- Click checkboxes next to issue keys
- Selection count appears at top ("X selected")
- Can select across multiple pages if needed
- Blue selection bar appears with Edit button

Expected Result: Multiple issues selected with blue "X selected Edit" bar visible

Step 6.2: Assign Issues to Shopping Cart Epic



Screenshot at 42:20

[Frame:152][Frame:153]

Navigation: Select issues → Drag to Epic or use bulk edit

Action:

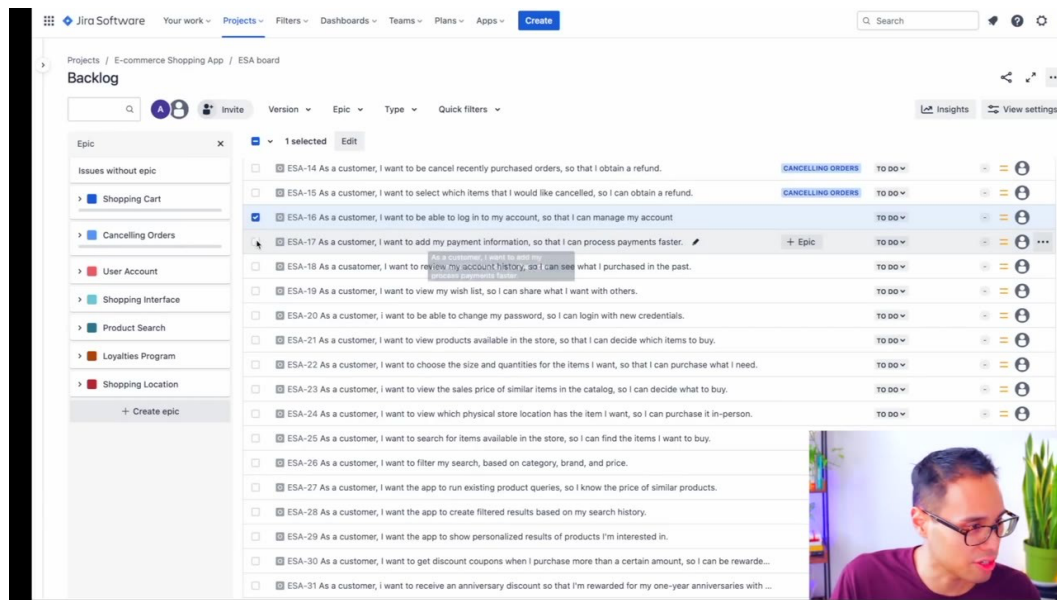
Assign shopping cart related user stories to the Shopping Cart epic by dragging them to the epic in the left panel.

Details:

- Select issues ESA-8 through ESA-13 (shopping cart functionality)
- Drag to "Shopping Cart" epic in left panel
- Epic assignment appears in Epic column

Expected Result: Selected issues now show "SHOPPING CART" in Epic column

Step 6.3: Continue Epic Assignments



Screenshot at 42:35

[Frame:155][Frame:156]

Navigation: Continue selecting and assigning remaining issues

Action:

Systematically assign all user stories to their appropriate epics based on functionality.

Details:

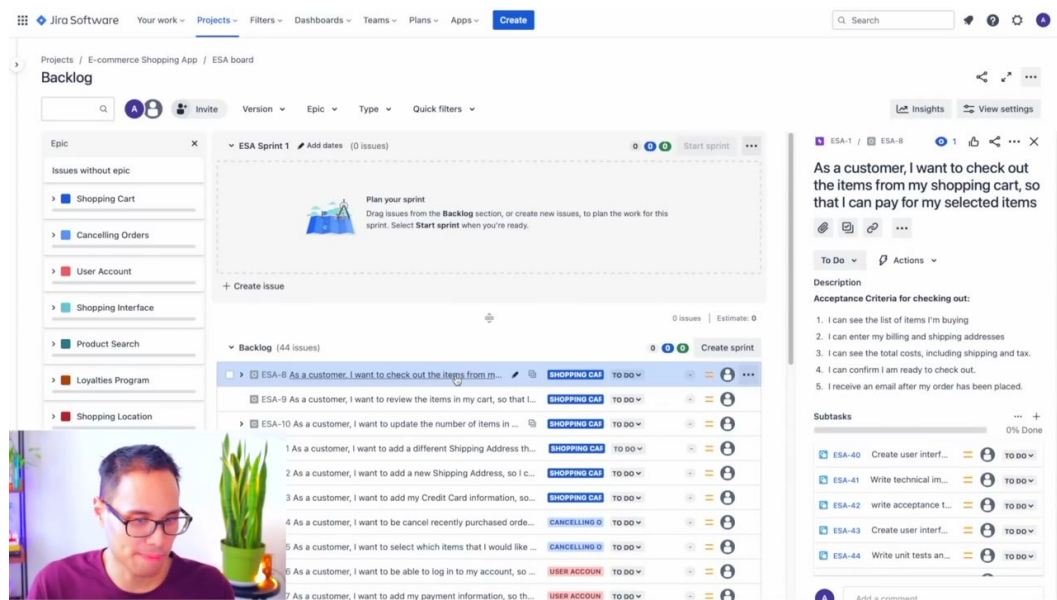
Assign issues to epics as follows:

- ESA-14, ESA-15: Cancelling Orders
- ESA-16 through ESA-20: User Account
- ESA-21 through ESA-24: Shopping Interface
- ESA-25 through ESA-29: Product Search
- ESA-30 through ESA-32: Loyalties Program
- ESA-33 through ESA-35: Shopping Location

Expected Result: All user stories assigned to appropriate epics, organized by functionality

Section 7: Adding Labels for Categorization

Step 7.1: Open Issue Details



Screenshot at 47:20

[Frame:177][Frame:178]

Navigation: Backlog → Click on issue summary

Action:

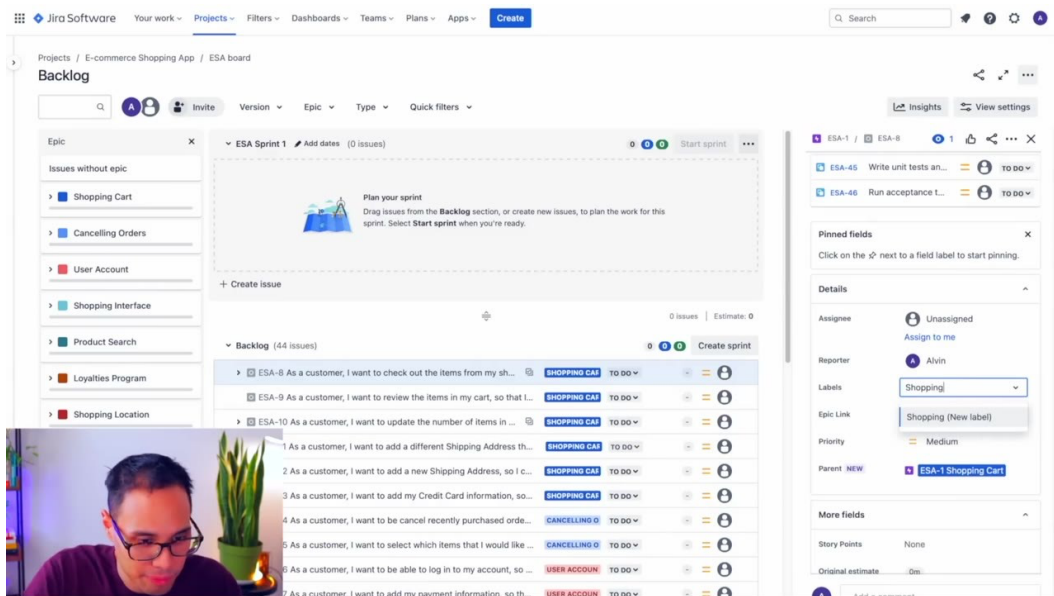
Click on a user story summary to open the issue detail panel on the right side.

Details:

- Right panel shows all issue information
- Scroll down to see Labels field in Details section
- Labels field initially shows "None"

Expected Result: Issue detail panel opens showing Labels field

Step 7.2: Add Shopping Label



Screenshot at 47:45

[Frame:179][Frame:180]

Navigation: Issue details → Labels field

Action:

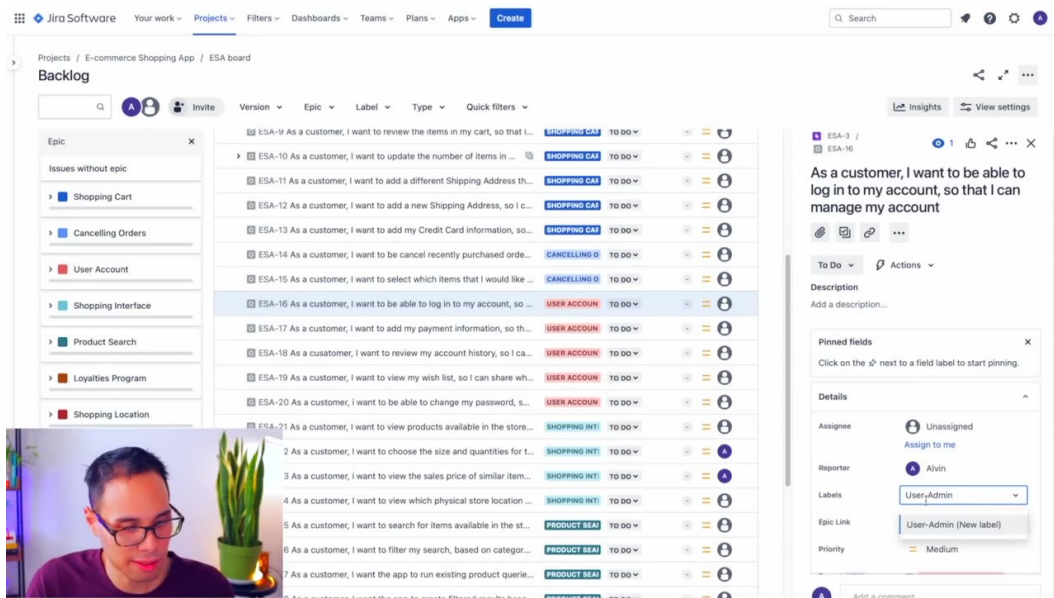
Click in the Labels field and type "Shopping" to create and assign the label.

Details:

- Type "Shopping" for shopping-related epics
- Labels are one-word categorization tags
- Used for filtering and searching issues
- Keyboard shortcut "L" can assign labels quickly

Expected Result: "Shopping" label applied to issue

Step 7.3: Apply Labels to Issue Groups



Screenshot at 49:40

Navigation: Continue labeling issues by category

Action:

Apply consistent labels to groups of related issues based on their functionality.

Details:

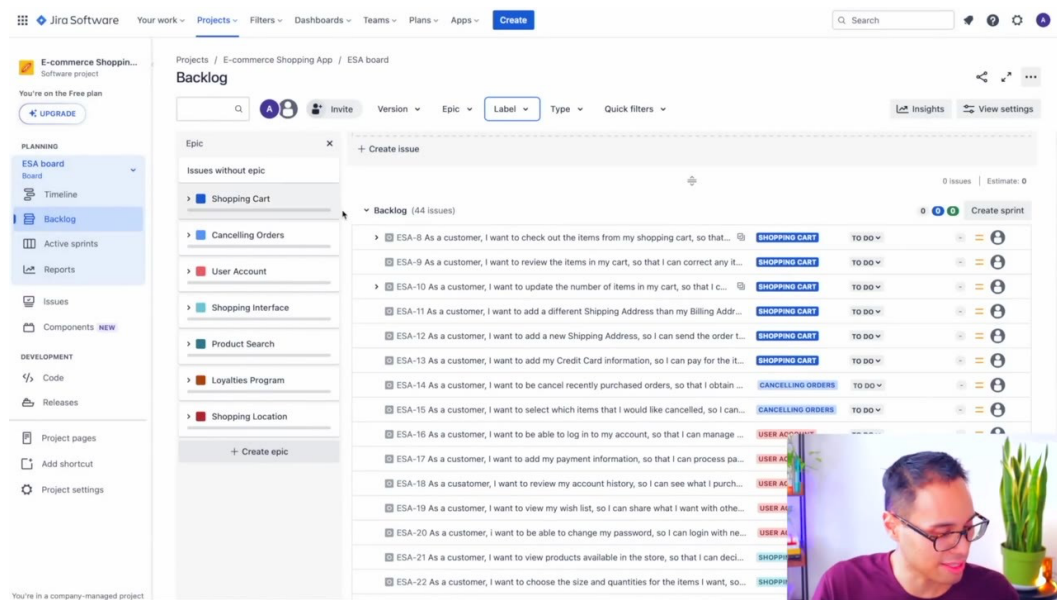
Apply these labels systematically:

- "Shopping": Shopping Cart, Cancelling Orders, Shopping Interface, Product Search epics
- "User-Admin": User Account, Loyalties Program epics
- "Store-Info": Shopping Location epic
- Apply to bugs based on the functionality they affect

Expected Result: All issues have appropriate labels for easy filtering and organization

Section 8: Using Components for Sub-sections

Step 8.1: Navigate to Components



Screenshot at 51:50

[Frame:206][Frame:207]

Navigation: Left sidebar → Components NEW

Action:

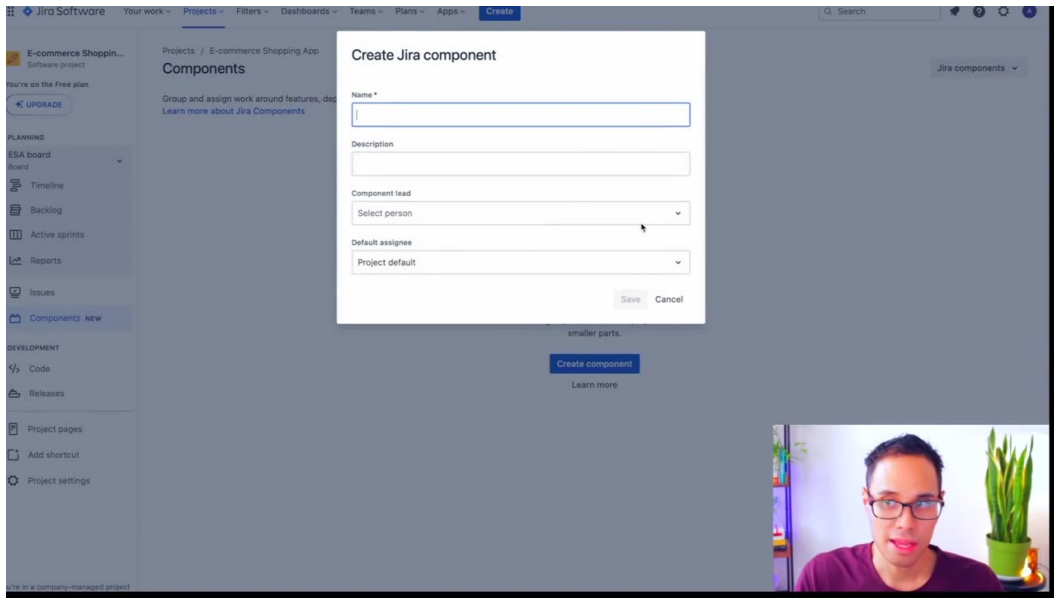
Click on "Components NEW" in the left sidebar to access the components management section.

Details:

- Components group work around features, departments, or workstreams
- Useful for organizing work by technical platform or team responsibility
- Initially shows "This project doesn't have any components, yet"

Expected Result: Components page opens with create component option

Step 8.2: Create iOS Component



Screenshot at 53:15

[Frame:213][Frame:214]

Navigation: Components page → Create component button

Action:

Create the first component for iOS platform compatibility.

Details:

- Name: iOS
- Description: Compatibility for iOS Devices
- Component lead: Alvin (your name)
- Default assignee: Project default

Expected Result: iOS component created and appears in components list

Step 8.3: Create Additional Components

Projects / E-commerce Shopping App

Components

Group and assign work around features, departments, or workstreams specific to your project.
Learn more about Jira Components

Search:

Component	Description	Component lead	Default assignee	Issues	
iOS	Compatibility for iOS Devices	Alvin	Component lead	0 issues	...
Android	Compatibility for Android Devices		Project default	0 issues	...

Want to group and track work around software components?

Create a catalog of software components in Compass, then link them to issues – so your team can group, track, and reveal the impact of their work on your software architecture.

To get started, get Compass for free and switch to Compass components on this page.

[Get Compass free](#) [Learn more about Compass](#)

Compass

Android added

Screenshot at 54:35

Navigation: Continue creating components for other platforms

Action:

Create components for all major platforms your application will support.

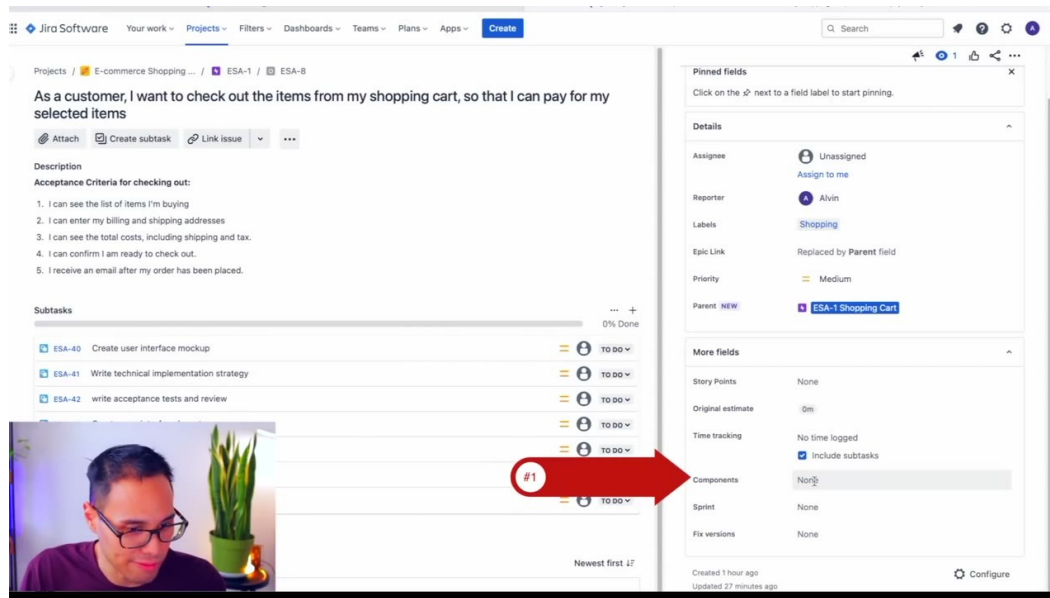
Details:

Create these components:

- Android: Compatibility for Android Devices
- Windows: Compatibility for Windows Devices
- macOS: Compatibility for macOS Devices (if applicable)

Expected Result: All platform components listed in components management

Step 8.4: Assign Component to Issue



Screenshot at 55:10

[Frame:221][Frame:222]

Navigation: Issue details → Components field

Action:

Open an issue's detail panel and assign it to the appropriate component.

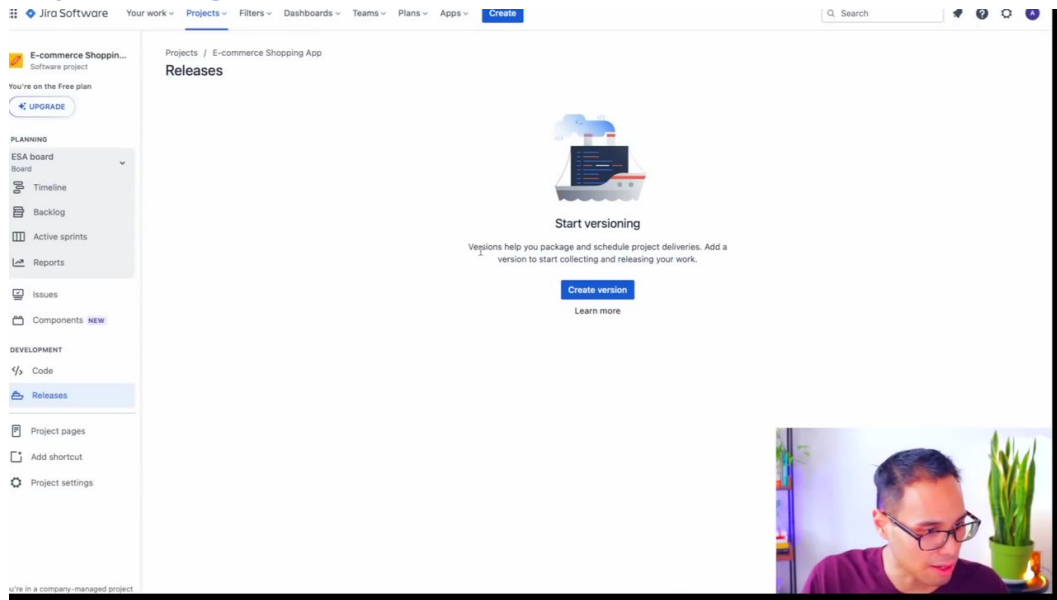
Details:

- Navigate to issue detail view
- Find Components field in Details section
- Select "iOS" component from dropdown
- Issue now associated with iOS platform work

Expected Result: Component assignment appears in issue details and components count updates

Section 9: Using Releases to Track Versions

Step 9.1: Navigate to Releases



Screenshot at 56:45

Navigation: Left sidebar → Releases

Action:

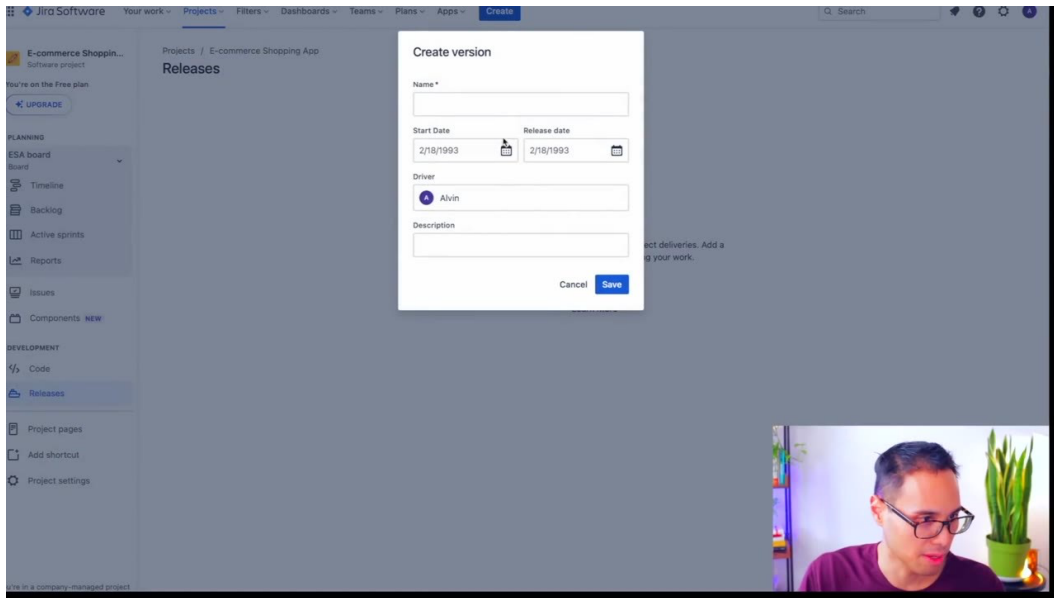
Click on "Releases" in the left sidebar to access version management.

Details:

- Releases help track different versions of your product
- Shows "Start versioning" prompt initially
- Versions organize work by release cycles

Expected Result: Releases page opens with "Create version" option

Step 9.2: Create Version 1



Screenshot at 57:05

[Frame:229][Frame:230][Frame:231]

Navigation: Releases page → Create version

Action:

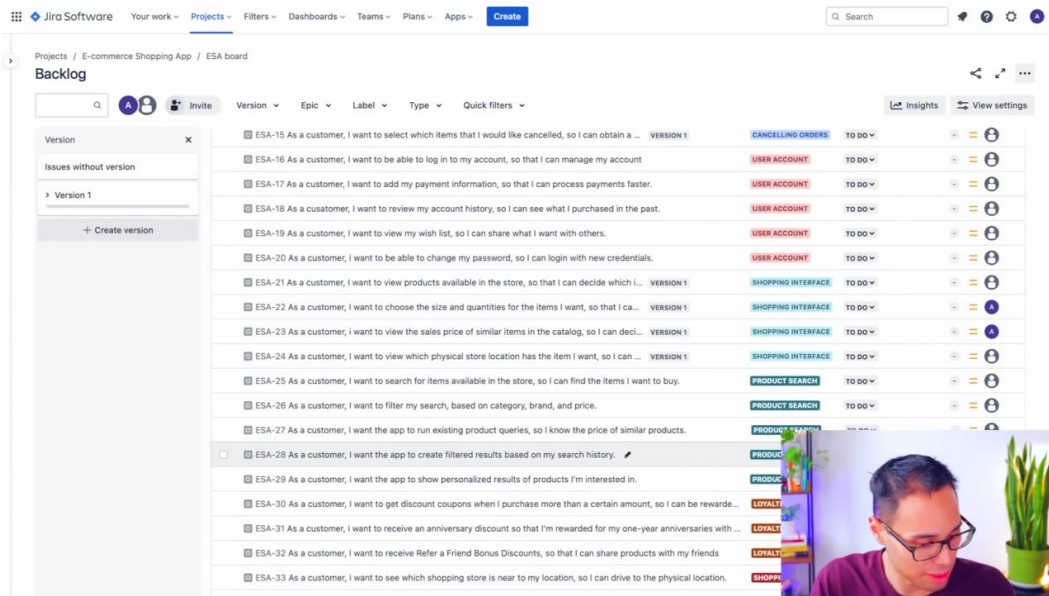
Create the first version with start and release dates.

Details:

- Name: Version 1
- Start Date: 1/15/2024 (adjust to your timeline)
- Release date: 6/28/2024 (6 months later)
- Driver: Your name
- Description: Initial Release - Allow customers to buy products online

Expected Result: Version 1 created with "UNRELEASED" status

Step 9.3: Create Additional Versions



Screenshot at 60:30

[Frame:244][Frame:246][Frame:247]

Navigation: Backlog → Version sidebar → Create version

Action:

Create Version 2.0 for beta features and Version 3 for future enhancements.

Details:

Version 2.0:

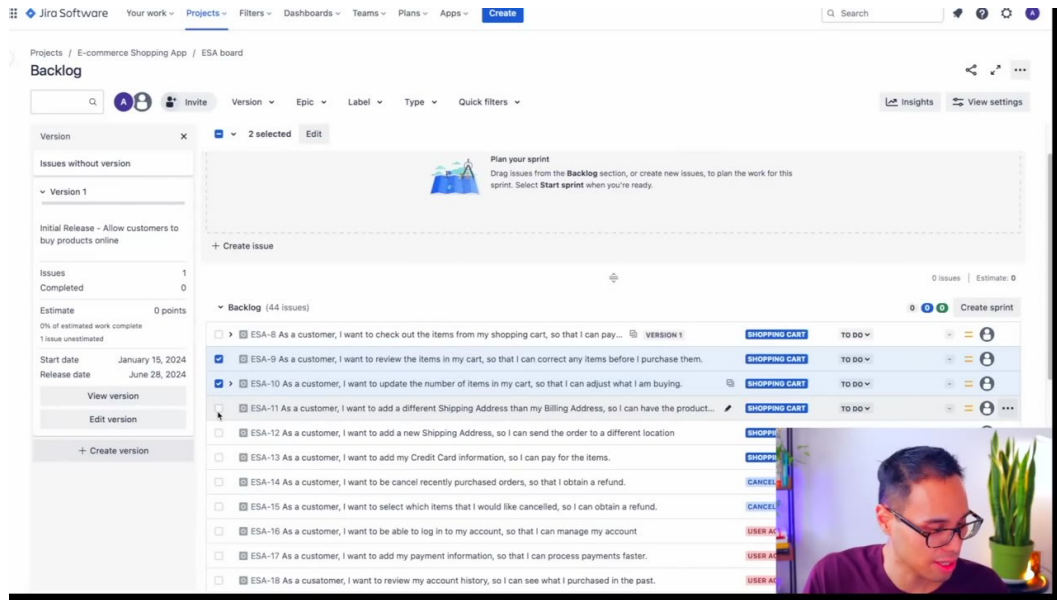
- Start Date: 7/1/2024
- Release Date: 9/30/2024
- Description: Beta Releases - User Accounts & Product Searches

Version 3:

- Start Date: 10/1/2024
- Release Date: 12/31/2024
- Description: Final Release - All Features Complete

Expected Result: Multiple versions available for issue assignment

Step 9.4: Assign Issues to Versions



Screenshot at 59:50

[Frame:238][Frame:239]

Navigation: Backlog → Select issues → Bulk assign version

Action:

Select groups of issues and assign them to appropriate versions based on priority and development timeline.

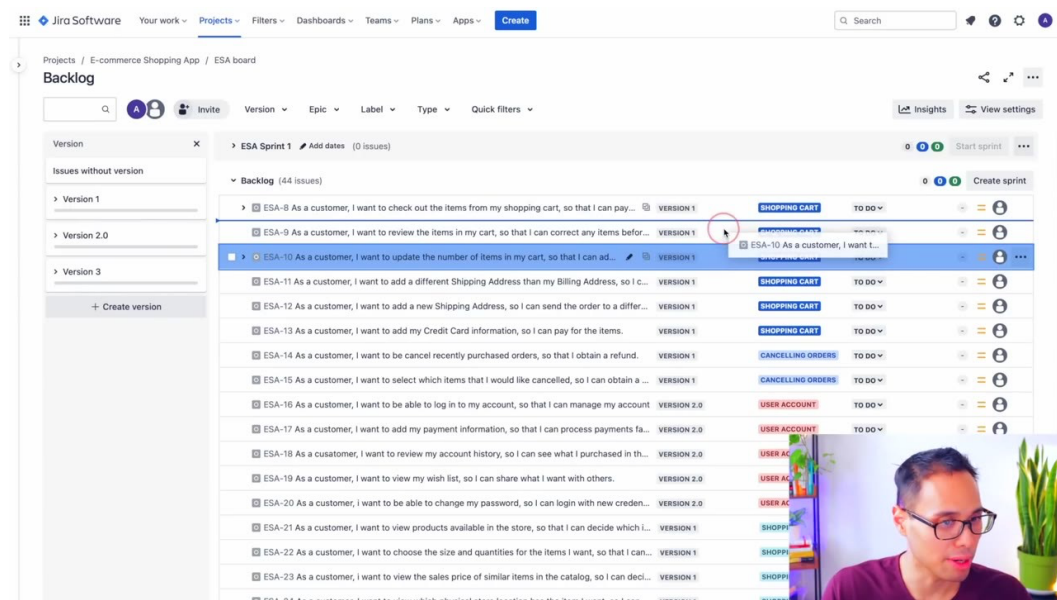
Details:

- Select core shopping cart issues for Version 1
- Assign user account features to Version 2.0
- Advanced features go to Version 3
- Use bulk selection for efficiency

Expected Result: Issues display version tags and can be filtered by version

Section 10: Grooming and Prioritizing the Backlog

Step 10.1: Review Issue Priority



Screenshot at 65:10

[Frame:272][Frame:273]

Navigation: Backlog → Review individual issues

Action:

Review each issue's priority level and adjust based on business value and dependencies.

Details:

- Priority levels: Highest, High, Medium, Low, Lowest
- Higher priority items should be addressed first
- Consider dependencies between issues
- Business value should drive prioritization

Expected Result: Issues have appropriate priority levels set

Step 10.2: Estimate Story Points

Story point	Amount of effort required	Amount of time required	Task complexity	Task risk or uncertainty
1	Minimum effort	A few minutes	Little complexity	None
2	Minimum effort	A few hours	Little complexity	None
3	Mild effort	A day	Low complexity	Low
5	Moderate effort	A few days	Medium complexity	Moderate
8	Severe effort	A week	Medium complexity	Moderate
13	Maximum effort	A month	High complexity	High

Source: <https://asana.com/resources/story-points>

Screenshot at 77:45

[Frame:347][Frame:352][Frame:353]

Navigation: Backlog → Click story point field for each issue

Action:

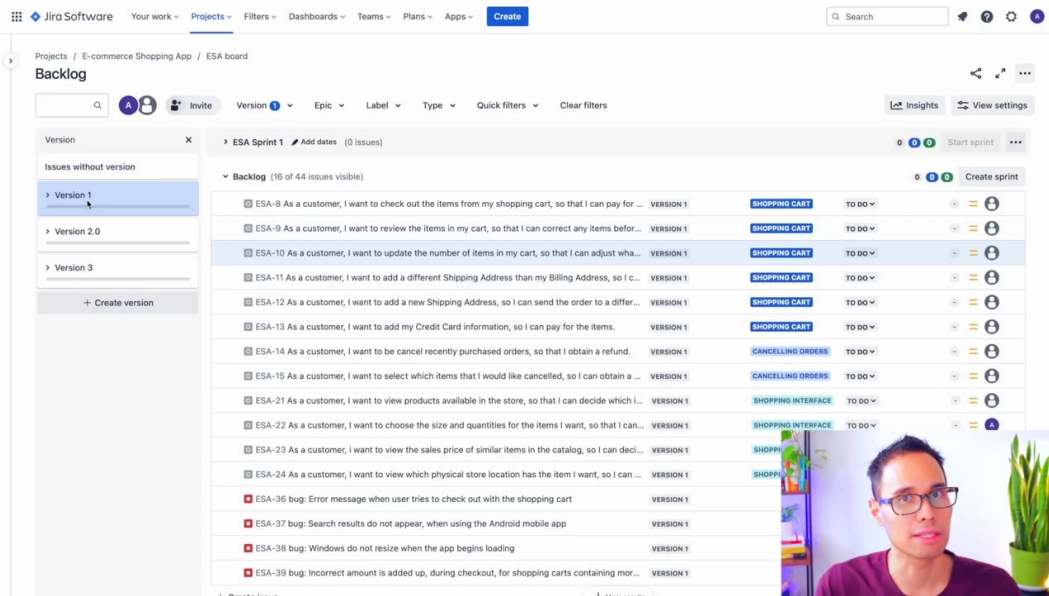
Assign story point estimates to each user story based on effort and complexity.

Details:

- Use Fibonacci sequence: 1, 2, 3, 5, 8, 13
- 1 point: Minimum effort, few minutes
- 3 points: Few hours of work
- 8 points: Multiple days of work
- Stories over 13 points should be broken down

Expected Result: Story point estimates appear in gray circles for each issue

Step 10.3: Filter by Version



Screenshot at 66:00

[Frame:275][Frame:276][Frame:277]

Navigation: Left sidebar → Version filters

Action:

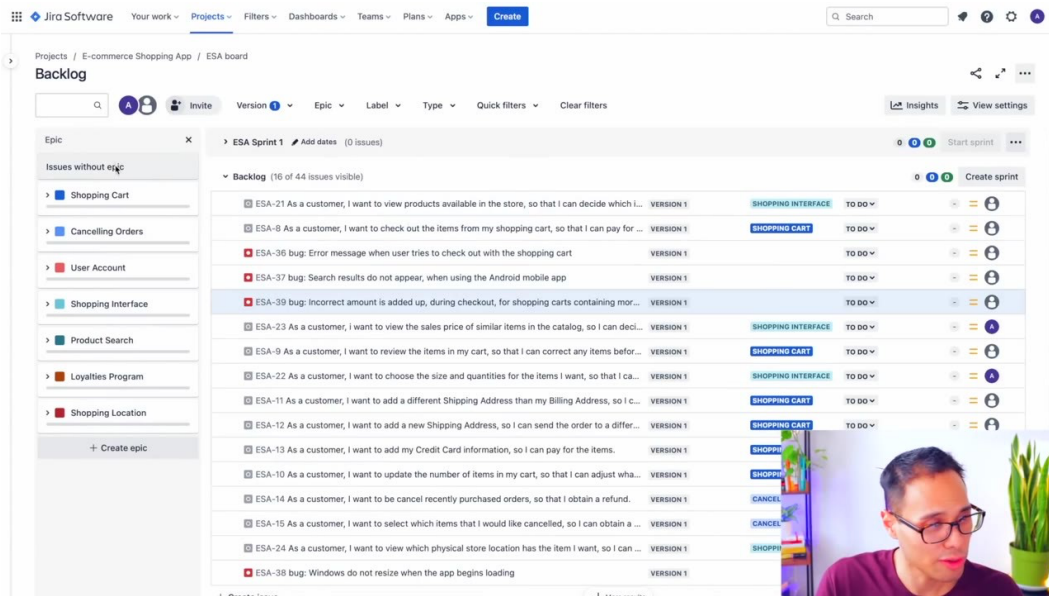
Use version filters to focus on specific release content and ensure proper prioritization.

Details:

- Click Version 1 to see only those issues
- Verify high-priority, foundational features are included
- Use keyboard shortcut "V" to toggle version panel
- Tooltip shows issue counts per version

Expected Result: Filtered view shows only issues for selected version

Step 10.4: Organize by Epic



Screenshot at 73:15

[Frame:314][Frame:315]

Navigation: Left sidebar → Epic panel

Action:

Review issues organized by epic to ensure proper feature grouping and completeness.

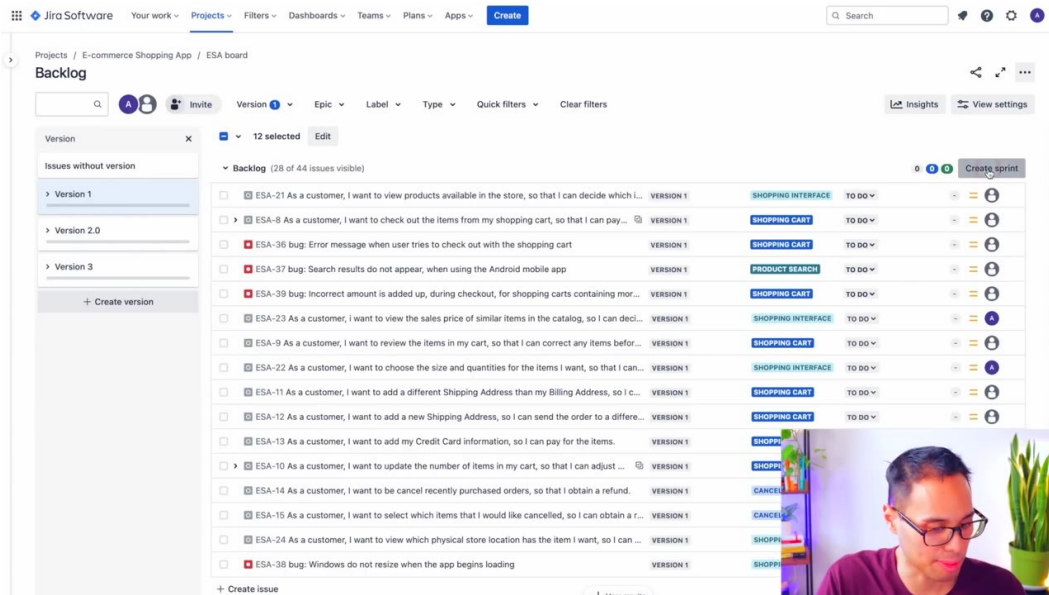
Details:

- Epic panel shows issues grouped by epic
- Verify all epics have sufficient user stories
- Check for missing functionality within epics
- Ensure epics are properly scoped for sprints

Expected Result: Issues properly organized and grouped by epic functionality

Section 11: Setting Up Your First Sprint

Step 11.1: Create Sprint



Screenshot at 76:30

[Frame:341][Frame:342]

Navigation: Backlog → Create sprint button

Action:

Create your first sprint container to plan upcoming work.

Details:

- Click "Create sprint" button in backlog
- Empty sprint section appears at top of backlog
- Sprint will contain selected issues for development
- Shows "Plan your sprint" instructions

Expected Result: ESA Sprint 1 section appears with planning instructions

Step 11.2: Add Issues to Sprint

The screenshot displays the Jira Software interface for the 'E-commerce Shopping App' project. The 'Backlog' section is active, showing a list of 16 issues. The issues are categorized by version (Version 1, Version 2.0, Version 3) and priority. The 'Sprint' section is also visible, showing a list of 16 issues. A video inset in the bottom left corner shows a person speaking.

Issue ID	Summary	Version	Category	Status	Priority	Assignee
ESA-21	As a customer, I want to view products available in the store, so that I can decide wh...	VERSION 1	SHOPPING INTERFACE	TO DO	5	A
ESA-8	As a customer, I want to check out the items from my shopping cart, so that I can...	VERSION 1	SHOPPING CART	TO DO	8	A
ESA-36	bug: Error message when user tries to check out with the shopping cart	VERSION 1	SHOPPING CART	TO DO	-	A
ESA-37	bug: Search results do not appear, when using the Android mobile app	VERSION 1	PRODUCT SEARCH	TO DO	-	A
ESA-39	bug: Incorrect amount is added up, during checkout, for shopping carts containing ...	VERSION 1	SHOPPING CART	TO DO	-	A
ESA-23	As a customer, I want to view the sales price of similar items in the catalog, so I can ...	VERSION 1	SHOPPING INTERFACE	TO DO	5	A
ESA-9	As a customer, I want to review the items in my cart, so that I can correct any items b...	VERSION 1	SHOPPING CART	TO DO	5	A
ESA-22	As a customer, I want to choose the size and quantities for the items I want, so that ...	VERSION 1	SHOPPING INTERFACE	TO DO	8	A
ESA-11	As a customer, I want to add a different Shipping Address than my Billing Address, s...	VERSION 1	SHOPPING CART	TO DO	3	A

Screenshot at 80:40

Navigation: Backlog → Drag issues to sprint section

Action:

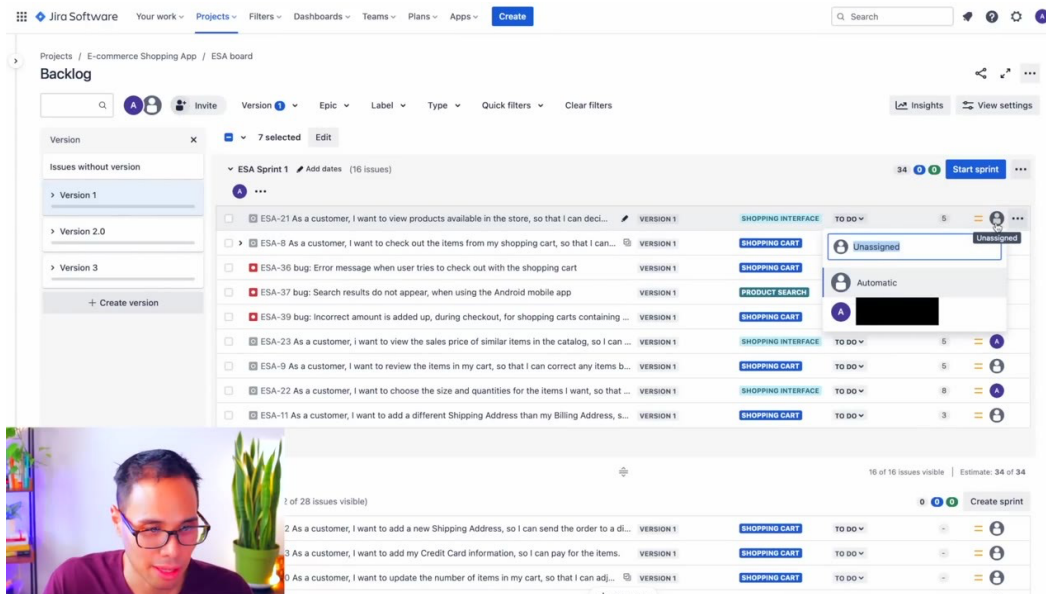
Select and move high-priority issues from the backlog into the sprint for execution.

Details:

- Drag issues from backlog to sprint section
- Start with highest priority Version 1 issues
- Include mix of user stories and any critical bugs
- Typical sprint contains 2-3 weeks of work

Expected Result: Issues moved into sprint section, showing issue count

Step 11.3: Assign Issues



The screenshot shows the Jira Software interface for a project named "E-commerce Shopping App". The user is viewing the "Backlog" of a sprint named "ESA Sprint 1". The interface includes a sidebar with a "Version" filter set to "Version 1". The main area displays a list of issues, each with a checkbox, a description, a version, a component, and a status. A dropdown menu is open for the "Assignee" field of the first issue, showing options like "Assigned", "Automatic", and "Unassigned". A video inset in the bottom left corner shows a person's face.

Issue ID	Description	Version	Component	Status	Assignee
ESA-21	As a customer, I want to view products available in the store, so that I can deci...	VERSION 1	SHOPPING INTERFACE	TO DO	5
ESA-8	As a customer, I want to check out the items from my shopping cart, so that I can...	VERSION 1	SHOPPING CART	TO DO	5
ESA-36	bug: Error message when user tries to check out with the shopping cart	VERSION 1	SHOPPING CART	TO DO	5
ESA-37	bug: Search results do not appear, when using the Android mobile app	VERSION 1	PRODUCT SEARCH	TO DO	5
ESA-39	bug: Incorrect amount is added up, during checkout, for shopping carts containing ...	VERSION 1	SHOPPING CART	TO DO	5
ESA-23	As a customer, I want to view the sales price of similar items in the catalog, so I can ...	VERSION 1	SHOPPING INTERFACE	TO DO	5
ESA-9	As a customer, I want to review the items in my cart, so that I can correct any items b...	VERSION 1	SHOPPING CART	TO DO	5
ESA-22	As a customer, I want to choose the size and quantities for the items I want, so that ...	VERSION 1	SHOPPING INTERFACE	TO DO	8
ESA-11	As a customer, I want to add a different Shipping Address than my Billing Address, s...	VERSION 1	SHOPPING CART	TO DO	3

Screenshot at 81:05

Navigation: Sprint issues → Assignee field

Action:

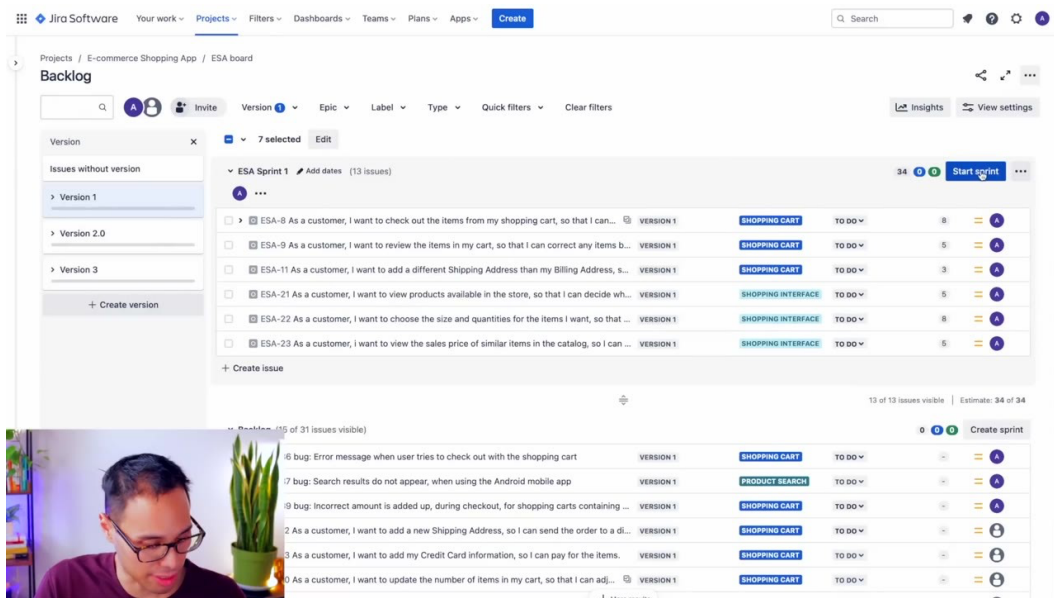
Assign team members to specific issues within the sprint.

Details:

- Click Assignee dropdown for each issue
- Assign to team members based on skills and capacity
- Can assign to yourself for learning purposes
- "Automatic" assignment uses component defaults

Expected Result: Issues show assignee avatars and names

Step 11.4: Start Sprint



Screenshot at 81:50

[Frame:365][Frame:366][Frame:367]

Navigation: Sprint section → Start sprint button

Action:

Launch the sprint by clicking Start sprint and configuring sprint parameters.

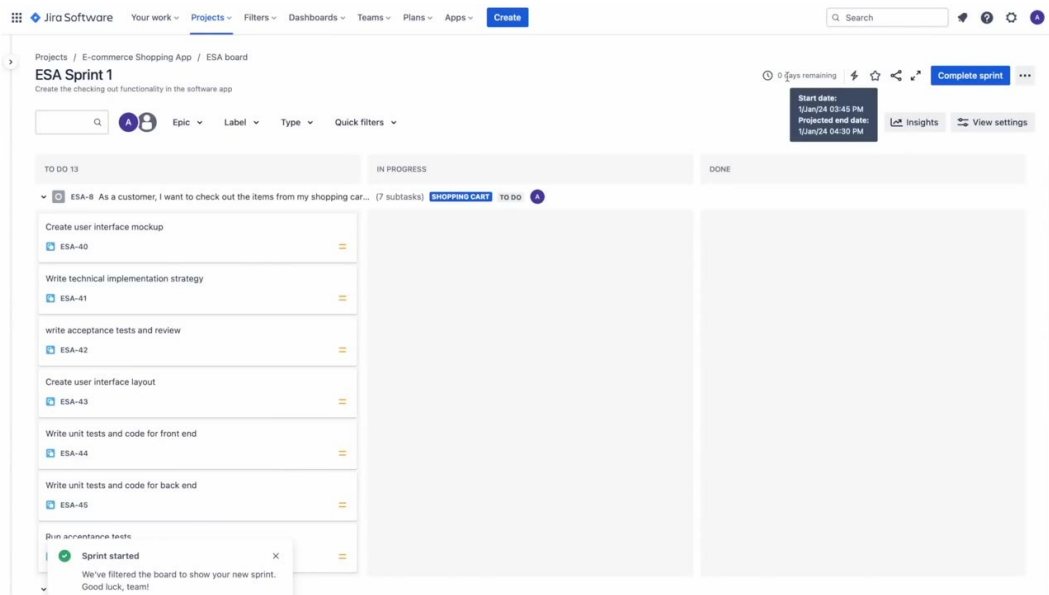
Details:

- Sprint name: ESA Sprint 1 (auto-populated)
- Duration: 2 weeks (typical)
- Start date: Current date and time
- End date: Calculated automatically
- Sprint goal: Optional description of sprint objectives
- Shows count of issues included

Expected Result: Sprint started notification and transition to active sprint board

Section 12: Working with the Sprint Board

Step 12.1: Navigate Active Sprint Board



Screenshot at 82:55

[Frame:368][Frame:369]

Navigation: Left sidebar → Active sprints or ESA board

Action:

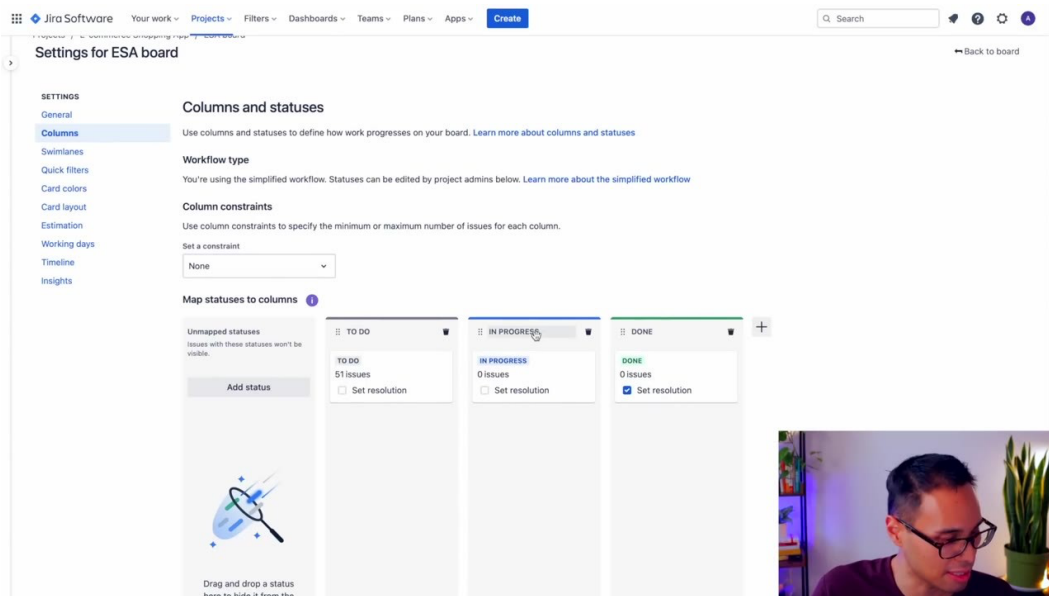
Access the active sprint board to manage work in progress during the sprint.

Details:

- Board shows columns: TO DO, IN PROGRESS, DONE
- Issues appear as cards that can be moved between columns
- Shows days remaining in sprint
- Complete sprint button available when ready

Expected Result: Kanban-style board with issue cards in TO DO column

Step 12.2: Add Custom Column



Screenshot at 84:35

[Frame:371][Frame:372]

Navigation: Board settings → Columns and statuses

Action:

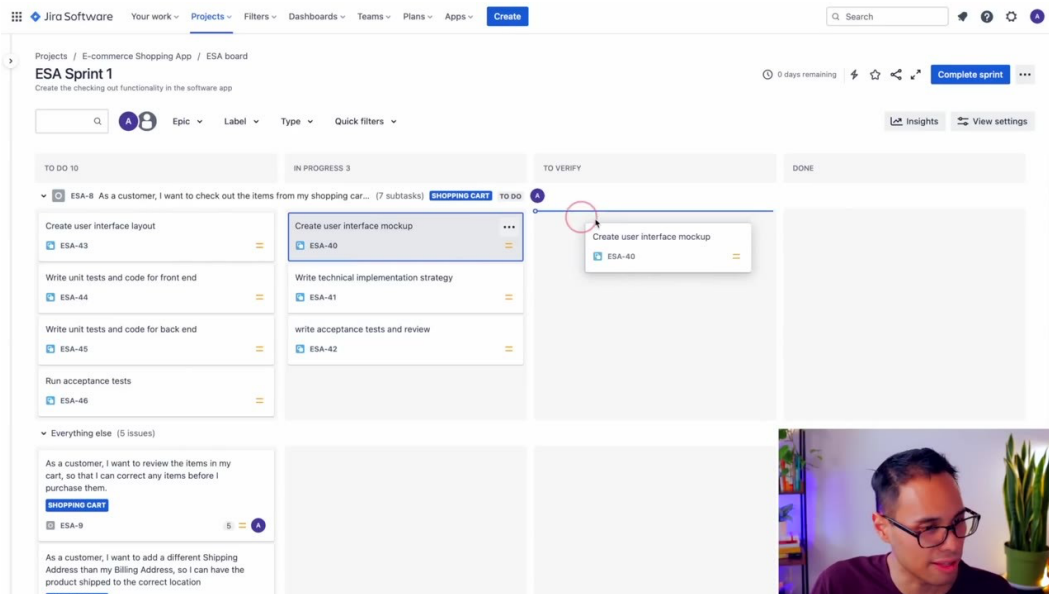
Add a "TO VERIFY" column for review workflow before completion.

Details:

- Access board settings from gear icon
- Click "Add column"
- Name: TO VERIFY
- Category: In Progress
- Helps separate development from testing/review

Expected Result: Board now has four columns: TO DO, IN PROGRESS, TO VERIFY, DONE

Step 12.3: Move Issues Through Workflow



Screenshot at 85:50

[Frame:374][Frame:375][Frame:377]

Navigation: Sprint board → Drag cards between columns

Action:

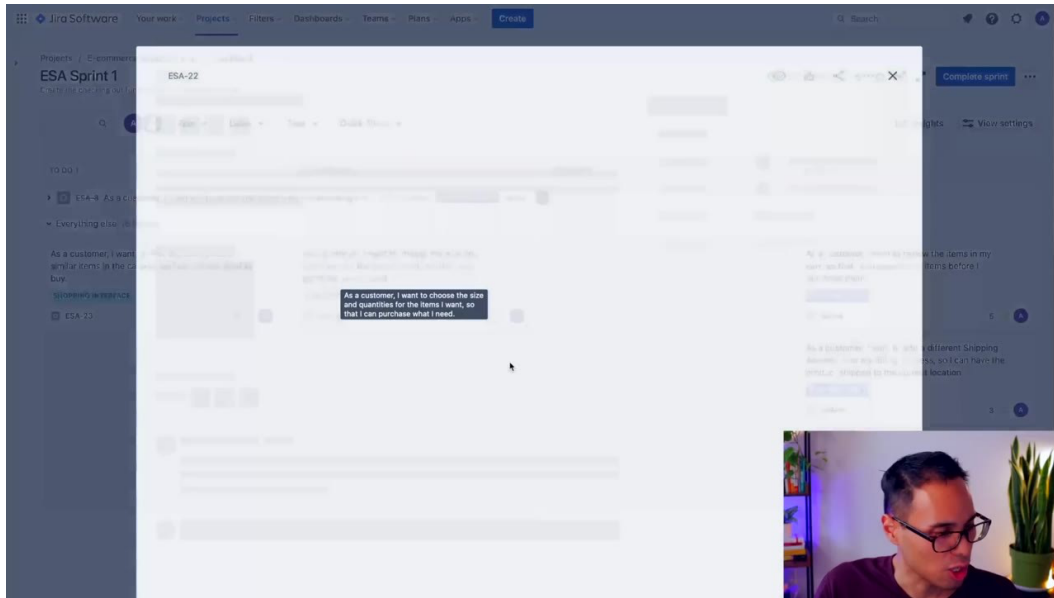
Move issue cards through the workflow columns as work progresses.

Details:

- Drag cards from TO DO to IN PROGRESS when starting work
- Move to TO VERIFY when ready for review
- Move to DONE when completely finished
- Column counts update automatically

Expected Result: Issues flow through workflow, column counts reflect current state

Step 12.4: View Issue Details



Screenshot at 87:40

Navigation: Sprint board → Click on issue card

Action:

Click any issue card to open detailed view for editing and reviewing progress.

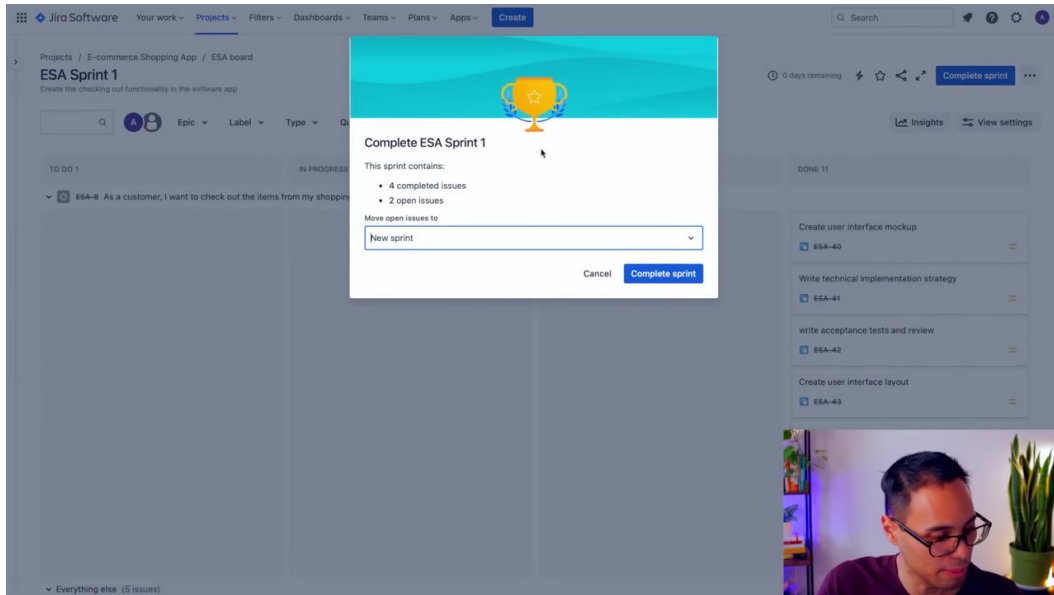
Details:

- Full issue details open in modal dialog
- Can edit description, assignee, status, etc.
- View acceptance criteria and subtasks
- Add comments and log work time

Expected Result: Issue detail modal opens with full information and edit capabilities

Section 13: Completing Sprints and Reporting

Step 13.1: Complete Sprint



Screenshot at 88:35

[Frame:382][Frame:383]

Navigation: Sprint board → Complete sprint button

Action:

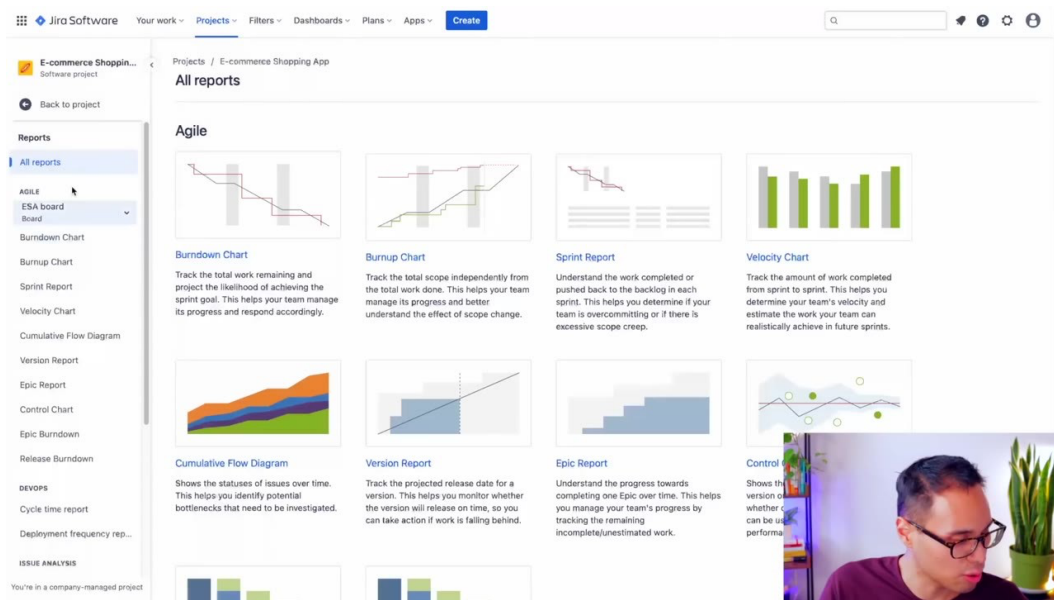
Complete the sprint when the time period ends, handling any incomplete work.

Details:

- Shows completed vs open issues count
- Choose destination for incomplete issues:
- Move to new sprint (creates automatically)
- Return to backlog for re-prioritization
- Completed issues remain in sprint history

Expected Result: Sprint completed and incomplete issues moved as specified

Step 13.2: View Sprint Reports



Screenshot at 89:50

[Frame:387][Frame:388][Frame:389]

Navigation: Left sidebar → Reports

Action:

Access various agile reports to analyze team performance and sprint outcomes.

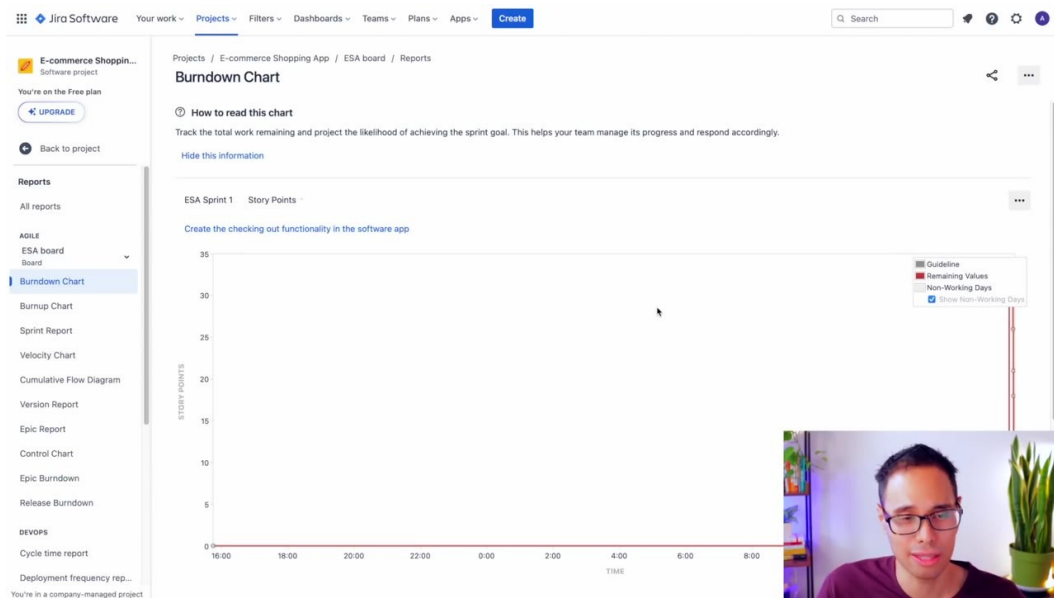
Details:

Available reports:

- Burndown Chart**: Shows story points completed over time vs planned
- Sprint Report**: Lists completed and incomplete work with details
- Velocity Chart**: Shows team's delivery rate over multiple sprints
- Cumulative Flow Diagram**: Visualizes work flow through statuses

Expected Result: Comprehensive reports showing sprint performance and team metrics

Step 13.3: Analyze Burndown Chart



Screenshot at 90:05

Navigation: Reports → Burndown Chart

Action:

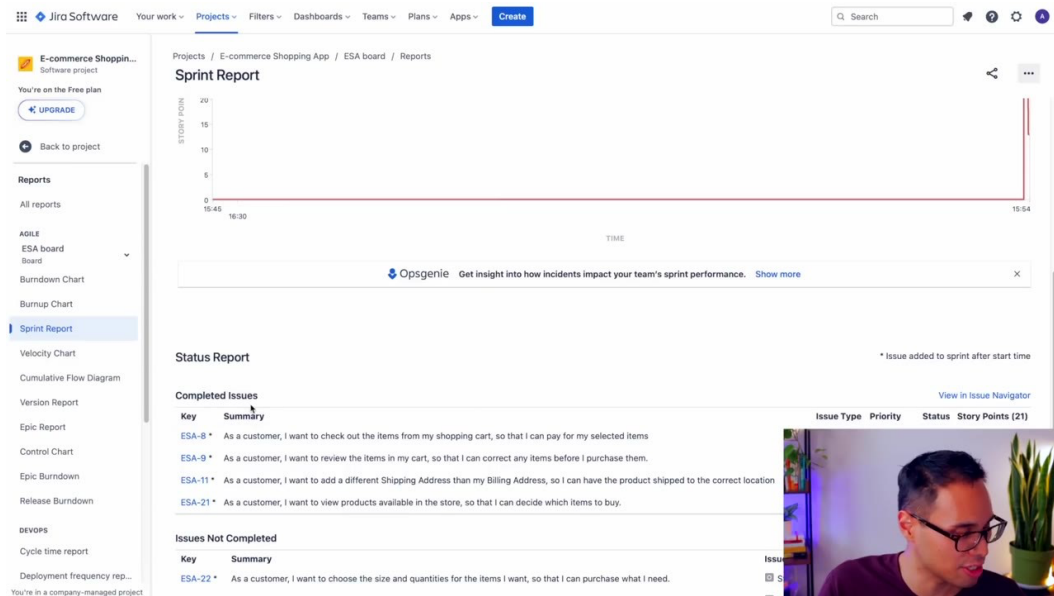
Review the burndown chart to understand how work progressed during the sprint.

Details:

- Y-axis shows story points remaining
- X-axis shows time progression
- Guideline shows ideal burndown rate
- Remaining value shows actual progress
- Non-working days are marked

Expected Result: Visual representation of sprint progress and team performance

Step 13.4: Review Sprint Report



Screenshot at 90:25

Navigation: Reports → Sprint Report

Action:

Examine detailed sprint report showing completed and incomplete work breakdown.

Details:

- Completed Issues**: Lists all work finished during sprint
- Issues Not Completed**: Shows incomplete work with reasons
- Status Report**: Summary of sprint outcomes
- Helps identify improvement areas for next sprint

Expected Result: Detailed analysis of sprint performance for retrospective discussions

PART 5: Configuration & Settings

User Roles and Permissions

Project Administrator:

- Full project configuration access
- Can create/modify workflows, fields, and permissions
- Manage project settings and team members

Project Member:

- Create, edit, and manage issues
- Participate in sprints and use boards
- View reports and project data

Viewer:

- Read-only access to project information
- Can view issues and reports but not modify

Keyboard Shortcuts

Essential Shortcuts:

- C*: Create new issue
- 1*: Switch to Backlog view
- 2*: Switch to Active Sprint board
- E*: Toggle Epic panel
- V*: Toggle Version panel
- L*: Add label to selected issue
- [*]: Toggle left sidebar collapse/expand

Issue Field Configuration

Standard Fields Available:

- Summary (required)
- Description (rich text with formatting)
- Issue Type (Epic, Story, Task, Bug, Sub-task)
- Status (To Do, In Progress, Done)
- Priority (Highest to Lowest)
- Assignee (person picker)
- Reporter (auto-populated)
- Labels (multi-select tags)
- Components (multi-select)
- Fix Version/s (release assignment)
- Epic Link (parent Epic)
- Story Points (estimation)
- Sprint (current sprint assignment)

Workflow Customization

Status Configuration:

- Custom statuses can be added beyond To Do/In Progress/Done
- Example: To Verify, Code Review, Testing
- Statuses map to board columns

- Transitions between statuses can be restricted by role

Board Column Setup:

- Columns map to workflow statuses
- Can have multiple statuses per column
- WIP (Work In Progress) limits can be set
- Column ordering reflects workflow sequence

Agile Configuration Options

Sprint Settings:

- Duration typically 1-4 weeks (2 weeks recommended)
- Sprint naming conventions
- Sprint goals and descriptions
- Sprint capacity planning

Estimation Options:

- Story Points (Fibonacci: 1,2,3,5,8,13,21)
- Time-based estimation (hours/days)
- T-shirt sizing (XS, S, M, L, XL)
- Custom estimation scales

Report Configuration:

- Burndown chart time periods
- Velocity chart sprint ranges
- Custom report filters and groupings

Summary

This comprehensive manual covered 13 major sections and 50+ detailed steps for mastering Jira Software:

1. **Account Setup and Project Creation** (3 steps)
2. **Interface Navigation** (2 steps)
3. **Epic Creation** (3 steps)
4. **User Story and Issue Management** (3 steps)
5. **Bug and Subtask Creation** (2 steps)
6. **Epic Assignment Organization** (3 steps)

7. **Label Categorization** (3 steps)
8. **Component Management** (4 steps)
9. **Version/Release Tracking** (4 steps)
10. **Backlog Grooming** (4 steps)
11. **Sprint Planning** (4 steps)
12. **Sprint Execution** (4 steps)
13. **Completion and Reporting** (4 steps)

The training used a realistic e-commerce shopping application project with 7 epics, 30+ user stories, bugs, and subtasks to demonstrate every aspect of agile project management in Jira Software.

Key Takeaways

Essential Agile Concepts

- **Iterative Development****: Build and release incrementally rather than waiting until the end
- **Sprint-Based Planning****: Use time-boxed periods (typically 2 weeks) for focused work delivery
- **Continuous Feedback****: Adapt to changing requirements through regular stakeholder review
- **Team Collaboration****: Daily standups, sprint planning, and retrospectives keep teams aligned

Jira Organization Best Practices

- **Hierarchical Structure****: Projects → Epics → Stories → Subtasks provides clear work breakdown
- **Consistent Naming****: Use clear, descriptive summaries following user story format
- **Proper Categorization****: Labels, components, and versions organize work for easy filtering
- **Regular Grooming****: Continuously prioritize, estimate, and refine the backlog

Sprint Management Excellence

- **Right-Sized Sprints****: 2-week duration balances planning overhead with flexibility
- **Capacity Planning****: Don't overcommit; leave buffer for unexpected work and impediments
- **Daily Progress****: Move work through defined workflow stages (To Do → In Progress → Done)
- **Completion Focus****: Finish work completely rather than starting everything at once

Effective Estimation Techniques

- Story Points**: Use Fibonacci sequence (1,2,3,5,8,13) to reflect uncertainty in larger estimates
- Relative Sizing**: Compare stories to each other rather than absolute time estimates
- Team Consensus**: Involve whole team in estimation for shared understanding
- Break Down Large Items**: Stories over 13 points should be split into smaller, manageable pieces

Reporting and Metrics Utilization

- Burndown Charts**: Track sprint progress and identify delivery risks early
- Velocity Tracking**: Understand team capacity over time for better sprint planning
- Sprint Reports**: Analyze completed vs incomplete work to improve future performance
- Retrospective Data**: Use reports to facilitate team improvement discussions

Configuration for Success

- Custom Workflows**: Add verification/review steps appropriate to your team's process
- Meaningful Components**: Organize work by technical areas, platforms, or team responsibilities
- Strategic Versioning**: Plan releases that deliver complete, valuable functionality
- Keyboard Shortcuts**: Master key shortcuts (C, E, V, L, 1, 2) for efficient navigation

Glossary

Agile: Iterative software development methodology emphasizing customer collaboration, responding to change, and delivering working software frequently

Backlog: Prioritized list of work items (user stories, tasks, bugs) waiting to be completed

Burndown Chart: Graph showing remaining work (story points) versus time in a sprint

Component: Logical grouping of issues within a project, often representing subsystems or team responsibilities

Epic: Large body of work that spans multiple sprints and contains multiple user stories

Issue: Generic term for any work item in Jira (story, task, bug, epic, subtask)

Kanban: Agile methodology using continuous flow without fixed-length iterations

Label: One-word tag used to categorize and filter issues

Scrum: Agile framework using fixed-length sprints with defined ceremonies and roles

Sprint: Time-boxed iteration (typically 2 weeks) where team commits to complete specific work

Story Points: Relative estimation unit reflecting effort, complexity, and risk

Subtask: Smallest unit of work, child of a user story, completable in one day

User Story: Feature description from end-user perspective following "As a..., I want..., so that..." format

Velocity: Measure of story points completed per sprint, used for capacity planning

Workflow: Sequence of statuses an issue moves through (To Do → In Progress → Done)

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